

Essentials of Innovation & Entrepreneurship (EIE) - II

Module (M1): Orientation, Introduction to EIE, Why Startups Fail

Icebreaker!!

Interactive Poll (Mentimeter)



Join at
www.menti.com

Use the code: 1436 7437



Meet the Team



Prof. Sathya Prasad
Lead Instructor, CIE@RR
(sathya.prasad@pes.edu)



Prof. Lakshmeesha
Lead Instructor, CIE@EC
(lakshmeesha@pes.edu)



Mr. Madhukar Narasimha
CIE Program Manager
(cieoffice@pes.edu)



Mr. Raghavendra Deshmukh
Co-Instructor, RR Campus, Industry Mentor
raghavendradeshmukh@pes.edu



Mr. Tarun Rama
CIE Ignite Manager
(tarunrama@pes.edu)

Department Coordinators
(Respective Departments)

E-Cell
Student body
(EC & RR campus)

Meet the Team



Chirag C Shekar

Teaching Assistant, Intern
chiragcshekar54@gmail.com



Pulkit Aggarwal

Teaching Assistant, Intern
pulkitaggarwal807@gmail.com
pes1ug23ee041@pesu.pes.edu

CIE Social Media Community



[@cie.pesu](https://www.instagram.com/cie.pesu)



[Center for Innovation and
Entrepreneurship @ PES University](https://www.linkedin.com/company/center-for-innovation-and-entrepreneurship-at-pes-university)



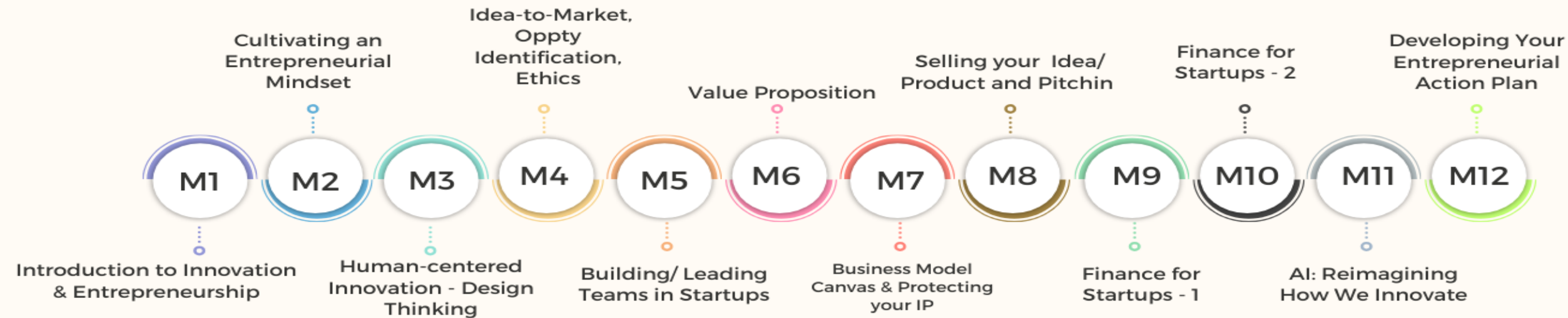
[@CIECommunity](https://discord.gg/CIECommunity)



ESSENTIALS OF INNOVATION & ENTREPRENEURSHIP - I (EIE I) (AUG-DEC 2025)



Course Modules:



Course Template:

Lectures			ISA	ESA
Case Studies	Video Discussions			
In-Session Quiz	End of session Quiz	External Speakers		
Integrated Hackathon and Mentorship				

CIE Spark: Idea/Problem Validation Sprint



Guest Speakers:

Industry(9)

K. Chandrashekar
Founder, CEO – Forus Health
Srivibhavan Balaram (Vibhav)
MD, VP – Stryker, Angel Investor
Raghavendra Bhat
Principal Engineer, AI – Intel
Raghavendra Bhat
Principal Engineer, AI – Intel
Varun Udbalker
AI Engineer – 4GoodAI

Harsha Chaturvedi
CEO – 4GoodAI, CTO – PESU
Medha Koppam
Microsoft Research, AI
Rahul Srinivas
CoS – AstraFin Neosolutions
Rakesh Godhwani
Founder – School of Meaningful Experiences (SoME)

Alumni Startup(5)

Ananya Mungara
CEO – Smart Chakra
Aditya Kolavi
Founder – Cognitive Labs
Abhilash Madabushi
Founder – Consuma.ai
Shashank Prabhakar
Co-Founder – draft42, Kaadoo Trails
Aditya
Co-Founder – Team Aalaap

Faculty(2)

Dr. Chitra
Head of Design, PESU
Prasanna Chandran
Industry Mentor – PESU CIE,
Consultant – Greywiz

16 Guest Speakers
21 Disciplines
4000+ Students (RR & EC campus)

Partners



Transforming Theory Into Practice



Founder / Expert Talks

- | | | |
|--|--|--|
| PESU Alums (11) <ul style="list-style-type: none"> Tushar Magar - (Founder, Daimyo) Manoj Sanker (Founder, Nemocare) Aditya Mehta (Founder, Epicure Robotics) Abhilash Madabhushi (Founder, Consuma.AI) Shashank Prabhakar (Founder, Kaadu Trails, draft42) Dhruv Shetty (Founder, Engineer) Keerthi Raghavendra (grad student, CMU) Shriya Desai (Deloitte) Samhitha Harish (EY) Parthan M (grad student, Aachen Univ) Shreyas Vedapatak - (8thSem Mech) | Faculty Experts(7) <ul style="list-style-type: none"> Prof. Nagarjuna S (Pro-VC) - Importance of Intrapreneurship Prof. Nidhi Srivatsa (Law) - IPR for Startups Prof. Manikandan (ECE) - Idea->Patent: What & How? Prof Ravi Urs (FOMC) - Digital Marketing, Digital Biz Models Prof. Sushma (Performing Arts)- Storytelling for Startups Dr. Jaykumar (BHEM) - Why/What/How | External Experts(6) <ul style="list-style-type: none"> John Kuruvilla (CEO) - Serial Entrepreneur; multi-area Krishnaprasad Jagadish (Founder CEO, Parjanya) - AR/VR & Media: startup journey Suresh Narasimha (CEO, Co-Create Ventures, PVL) - How to succeed in student-led startups Mr. S J Vijay (CEO) - India Pioneer, Building-as-a-Product Mr. Nithin Simakurti (CEO) - Service/Product company from scratch Sushma Krishnamurthy - InzpireU |
|--|--|--|

- | | |
|---|---|
| Students <ul style="list-style-type: none"> 4000+ 21 Disciplines 2 Campus | Dept <ul style="list-style-type: none"> FOMC Depts of Engg CIE TA's Industry Mentors |
|---|---|

CIE Ignite Jury

- Dr Sudeendra Koushik** BE, MBA, PG SM (IIM-K), PhD (INNOVATION).
- Bindu S. Sastry** Founder, MD, MAUVERICK
- Anand Sri Ganesh** CEO - NSRCEL, IIM Bangalore

CIE Ignite Sponsors

- Title Sponsor - **CiC (Co-Innovation Center by PESU & IHFC@IITD)**
- Platinum Sponsor - **InzpireU**
- Gold Sponsor - **4GoodAi**
- Category Sponsor - **SL Memorial**

CIE Ignite (Ideathon)



Stages	Preliminary Pitch(S1)	Team Pitch(S2)	Grand Finale(S3)
#Teams	484	94	10
Participants	3000	564	55

Grand Finale - 11th April 2025

Jan-April 2025

Total Prize Money - ₹70,000

- Winner - ₹25,000
- 1st Runners up - ₹15,000
- 2nd Runners Up - ₹10,000

Category Awards

- Prototype Pioneer Award - ₹5,000
- Blockbuster Visionary Award - ₹5,000
- All Girls Team - ₹5,000
- People Choice Award - ₹5,000

Course Template				
EIE II - 4 th Sem			ISA	ESA
Lectures				
Case Studies	Video Discussions			
In-Session Quiz	End of session Quiz	External Speakers		

Course Outline*

	Theme/Topic	CIE-Ignite Milestone*
M1	Orientation, Introduction to EIE, Why Startups Fail	
M2	Market Failure, Validation and Pretotyping	
M3	Customer Development (CD): Hypothesis & Assumptions	Stage0 (S0)
M4	Customer Development (CD): Interviews, Evidence	
M5	Customer Development (CD): Experiments & Customer loops	
M6	Startup Pitching	Stage1 (S1)
M7	Innovation Framing, Jobs-To-Be-Done (JTBD)	
M8	Marketing and Market Structure	Stage2 (S2)
M9	Startup Finance 201	
M10	Startup Finance 201 (Part 2)	Stage3 (S3)
M11	IP for Startups	
M12	Reflections, Synthesis, New Journey	

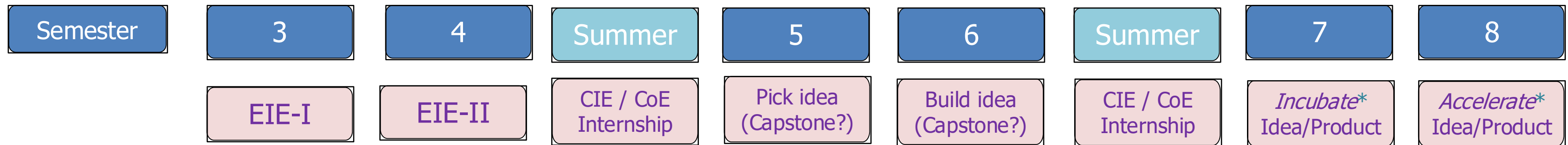
* Proposed, subject to modification

How Can EIE Help You in Your Education/Career?

We envision this to be more than a 'course':

- Discover your 'True North' / Interests / Passion
- Identify ideas/opportunities that you consider worth pursuing (tech/biz / startup/research / etc)
- Find potential collaborators/teammates/startup founders/innovators
- Get funding/prototyping/mentoring / etc support to build out your idea/team

Sample/Illustrative Example: One possible path (*not* the only path)



Build Tech, Business and Soft skills; Discover their 'True North'/passion, Teammates and more (build prototype/minimum-viable-product, validate, etc.)

Apply to CIE PESU-IITx Co-Innovation-Center (grant, mentorship) Corporate/Govt Incubator/Accelerator, Research Labs, etc.

** Faculty & Students*

Course Objectives

- Prepare you to kickstart your I&E Journey *now!*
- Provide a platform to apply your I&E skills (CIE Ignite)
- Exposure to transformative technology-driven innovations
- Interactions with Founders/VCs/Startup Ecosystem experts
- Deeper awareness and understanding of business acumen

**Fun way to prepare for an exciting/impactful
3rd/4th year PESU journey!**



Learning Outcomes

- Applying what you learned in **EIE-1** (BMC, VPC, Design Thinking, etc)
- Opportunity for you to (safely) create a startup by picking a real-world problem (opportunity) & solving it using proven principles
- Use Lean Startup & Customer Development principles for your idea
- “Evidence-based” vs. “faith-based” entrepreneurship
- Discover great teammates – potential/future Co-Founders!

How will you apply EIE learnings with your other Courses/Projects/Gig(s)?



Course Mechanics



Credits: 2 Credits (Weekly 2hr)

Engagement: Mostly Online (some sessions will be F2F with advance notice)

Will include talks by Startup Founders, Industry Experts, PESU Faculty, etc

Grading*: S: 90 –100 A: 80 –89 B: 70.-79 C: 60 –69 D: 50 –59 E: 40 –49 F: 39 & below

Assessment*: [CIE Ignite/ideathon](#)(10%), CBT - 2 ISAs (20% each) & 1 ESA (50%)

Attendance: **Same as university requirements (75%+)**

Dept Support: Contact the respective Depts Coordinator (DC) for assistance (see next slide)

References:

- Technology Ventures: From Idea to Enterprise, McGraw Hill
- PES University 'CIE Level 1' Course - [Getting Started With Entrepreneurship](#)
- VentureLab ([Entrepreneurial Skillset and Mindset](#))
- European Union (EU) [Entrepreneurship Competencies](#)

* Proposed, subject to modification



EIE Course Department Coordinators

Dept	Chairperson	Faculty DC	Mail ID
AIML	Dr. Jayashree R	Prof. Shwetha	shwethakn@pes.edu
BArch	Prof. Hemashree	Prof. Yashas Hegde	yashashegde@pes.edu
BA - Performing Arts	Dr Sushma S V	Ms. Prapujya Ramesh	prapujyaramesh@pes.edu
BCA	Dr. Veena S	Prof. Santosh Katti	santosh_katti@pes.edu
BDes	Prof. Chitra Vishwanathan	Prof. Smriti Haritz	smrthiharits@pes.edu
Biotech	Dr. Reshma	Dr. Jhinuk Chatterjee	jhinukchatterjee@pes.edu
CS	Dr. Shylaja S	Dr Gayathri T	gayathrit@pes.edu
ECE	Dr. Shika Tripathi	Dr. Sudeendra	sudeendrakumark@pes.edu
EEE	Dr. Rex Joseph	Dr. Sangeeta Modi	smodi@pes.edu
Mech	Dr. Rajesh Mathivanan	Dr. Kiran M	kiranm@pes.edu
BA LLB	Prof. Jomy George	Prof. Sangeetha Kumar	sangeethaskumar@pes.edu
BBA LLB	Prof. Jomy George	Prof. Sangeetha Kumar	sangeethaskumar@pes.edu
BBA	Dr. Jayashree Sapra	Prof. Sangeetha Kumar	sangeethaskumar@pes.edu
BBA-Sports Mgmt	Mr Vinay M S	Prof. Sangeetha Kumar	sangeethaskumar@pes.edu
BBA Bus Analytics	Dr. Jayashree Sapra	Prof. Sangeetha Kumar	sangeethaskumar@pes.edu
BBA HEM	Dr. Jaykumar V	Prof. Bhaskar Sailesh	bhaskars@pes.edu
Bcom General	Dr Anuradha Pai	Prof. Sangeetha Kumar	sangeethaskumar@pes.edu
BCom CMA	Dr Anuradha Pai	Prof. Sangeetha Kumar	sangeethaskumar@pes.edu
BSc Economics	Dr Anuradha Pai	Prof. Sangeetha Kumar	sangeethaskumar@pes.edu
BSc Psychology	Prof. Samini Mathew	Prof. Sangeetha Kumar	sangeethaskumar@pes.edu
Intl Accts & Finance	Dr. Shailashree Haridas	Prof. Sangeetha Kumar	sangeethaskumar@pes.edu

Session Quiz - FAQ

For a smooth Session Quiz experience, pls follow the below guidelines:

✓ Session-End Quiz – Instructions

1 Log in to **PESU Academy** and navigate to **My Quizzes** – you will find your test details there.

2 This will take you to the **Assessment Page**. Use the following credentials:

- 🔑 **PRN:** Your PRN Number
- 🔑 **Password:** Your PESU Academy password

3 If you are unable to log in to the assessment page, please email **support@pesuacademy.com** with the following details:

- ✓ SRN
- ✓ Name
- ✓ Screenshot of the My Quizzes tab at the time of the issue

4 If no test appears in **My Quizzes**:

- Log in at www.pesuacademy.com/Assessment
- Check if the message shows "*No Test Scheduled*"
- Take a screenshot as proof

How to Get the Best Out of this Course?

- Discipline, Perseverance & Commitment. (key ingredients of a successful entrepreneur!)
- Practice the framework/tools: Leverage CIE-Ignite (develop skills to use the 'tools'; not formulaic, find out what works best for you)
- Lots of 'doing' in a Team setting (if Team succeeds, you succeed)
- Leverage mentorship from CIE Industry Mentors for Team Project
- Use the new CIE arena and Makerspace to build your prototype
- Based on your efforts/results, apply for CIE Summer Internship

Student Engagement / Facilitation



Online

- Q/A on MS Teams (Moderated by CIE TAs)
- Polls
- Session Quiz on PESU Academy: **Important!** (this is how you get attendance)
- For course related assistance, reach out to cieoffice@pes.edu (Madhukar Sir)

Offline

- Department Coordinator (DC) in your respective Department





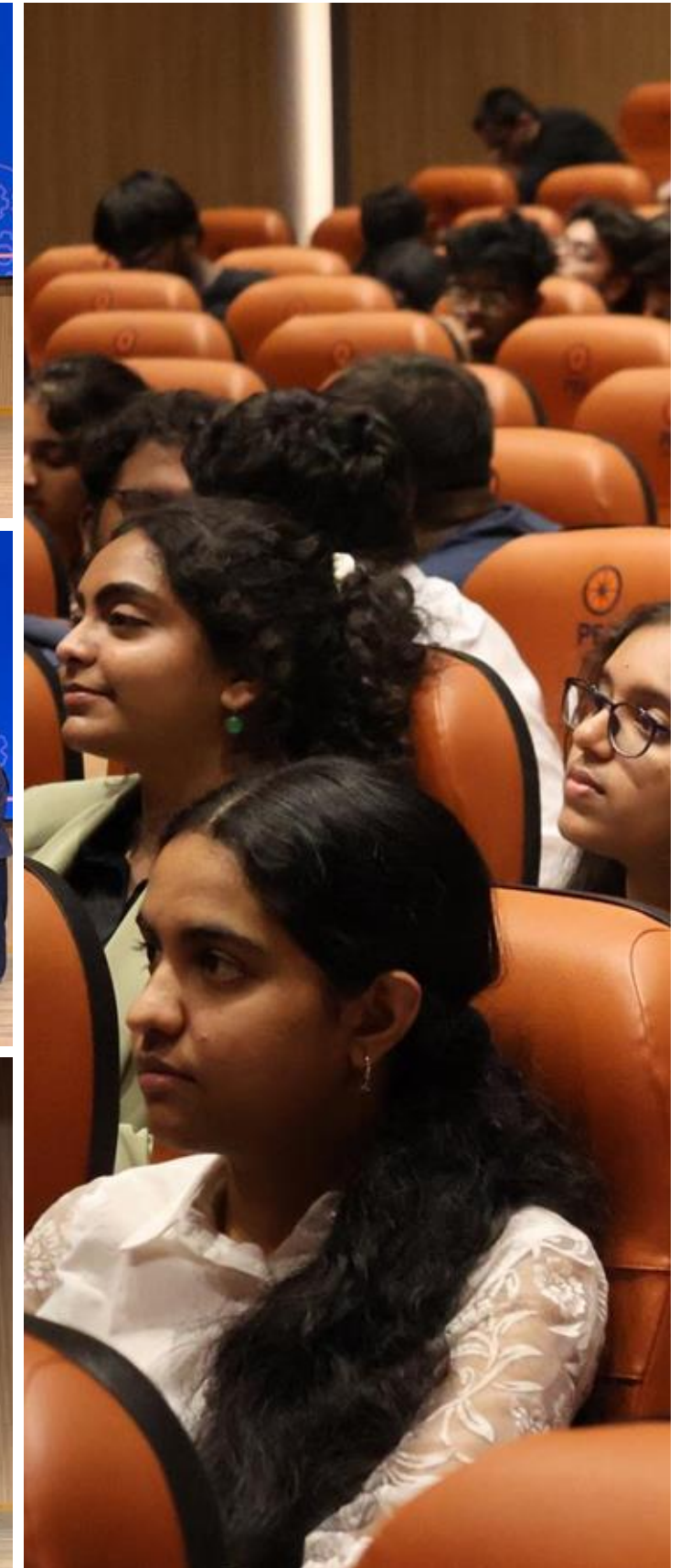
For Tomorrow's Innovators

CIE Ignite Season02: A curriculum-integrated innovation program delivering guaranteed engagement with 4,500+ engineering students at their most motivated moment.

From classroom theory to real-world impact!



Glimpse of CIE Ignite Season 01 - 2025



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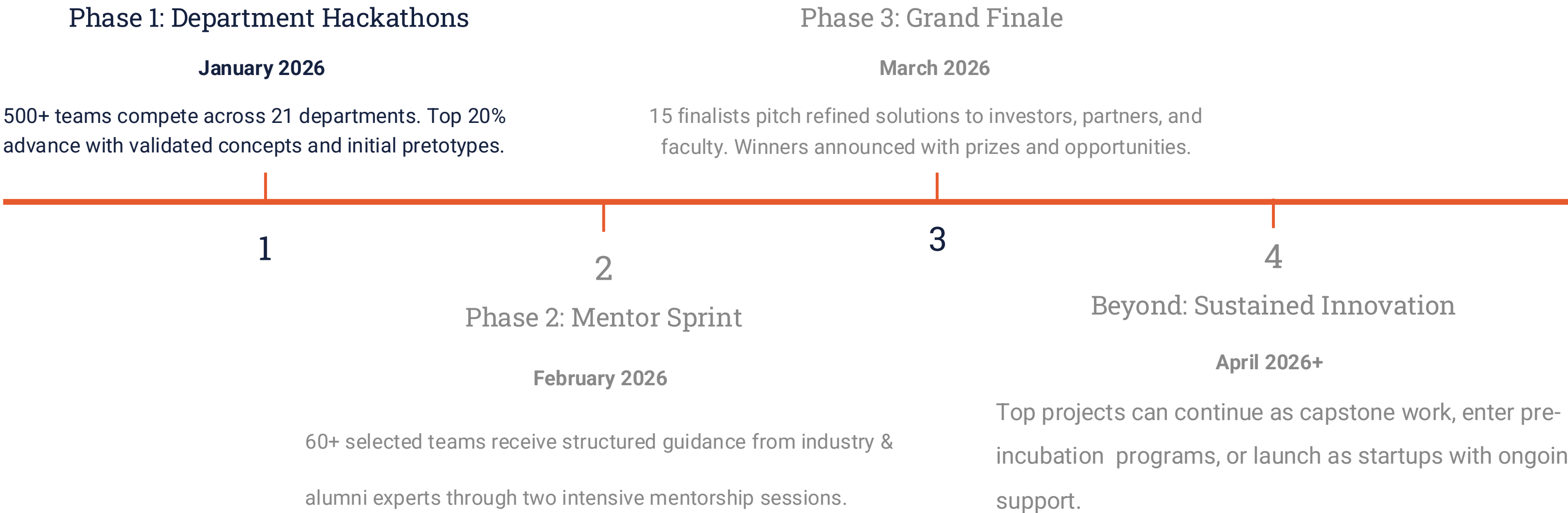
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KNOWLEDGE PARTNER

The CIE Ignite Journey

A three-phase innovation pipeline that transforms classroom learning into validated, market-ready solutions



Innovation starts here—and it does not stop.



Season 02 powers ideas into impact:

- Hackathons → Mentor Sprint → Grand Finale → Beyond
- Teams sharpen, validate, and pitch to real stakeholders
- Top projects continue as capstones, pre-incubation, or startups

Be part of the journey:

- Faculty: shape problem statements
- Industry: mentor, fund, and co-build
- Students: bring your best

Let us build market-ready solutions from PES!

Contact: tarunrama@pes.edu

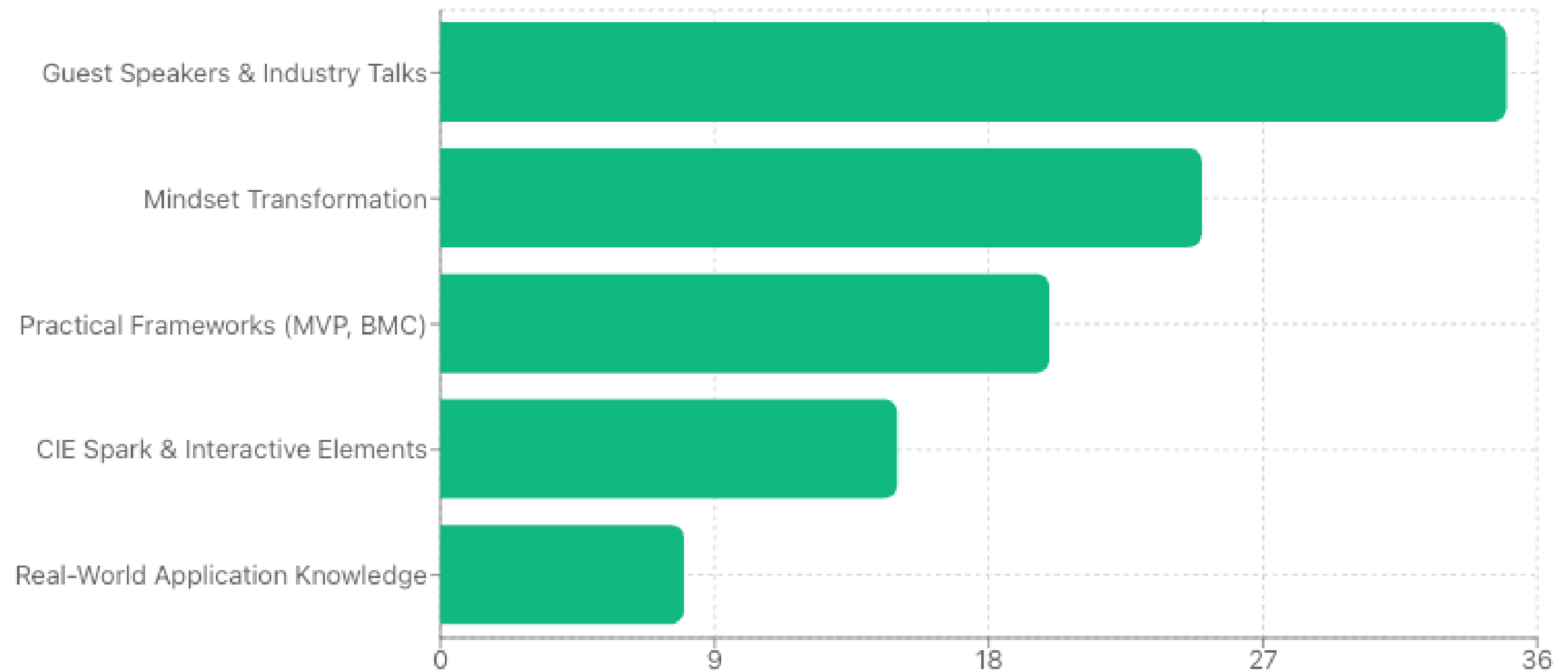
Visit: <https://cie.pes.edu/>



We Asked, You Responded

🌟 What Was a Game-Changer? (103 Students)

Top 5 Most Impactful Elements

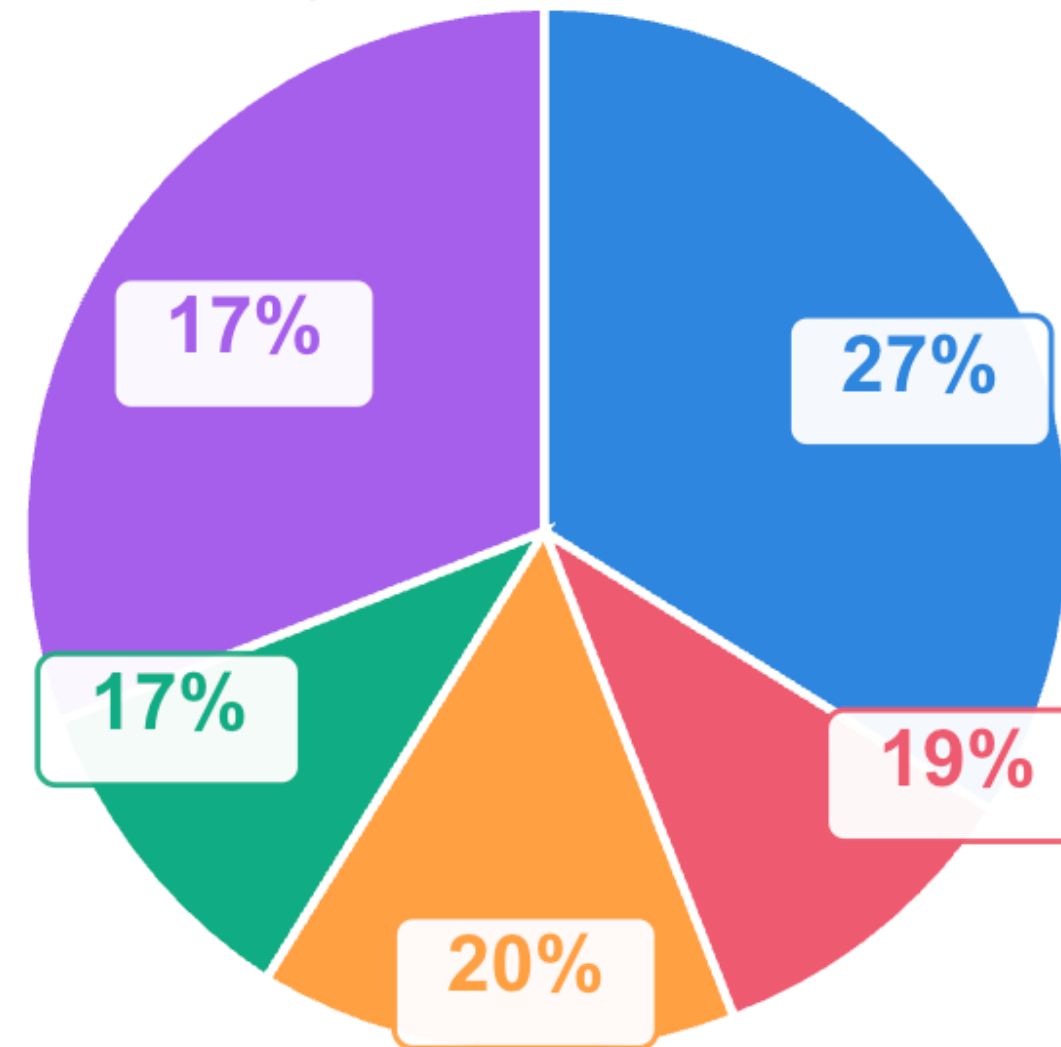


Who of you offered your PoV?



Who Gave Feedback?

Department Distribution



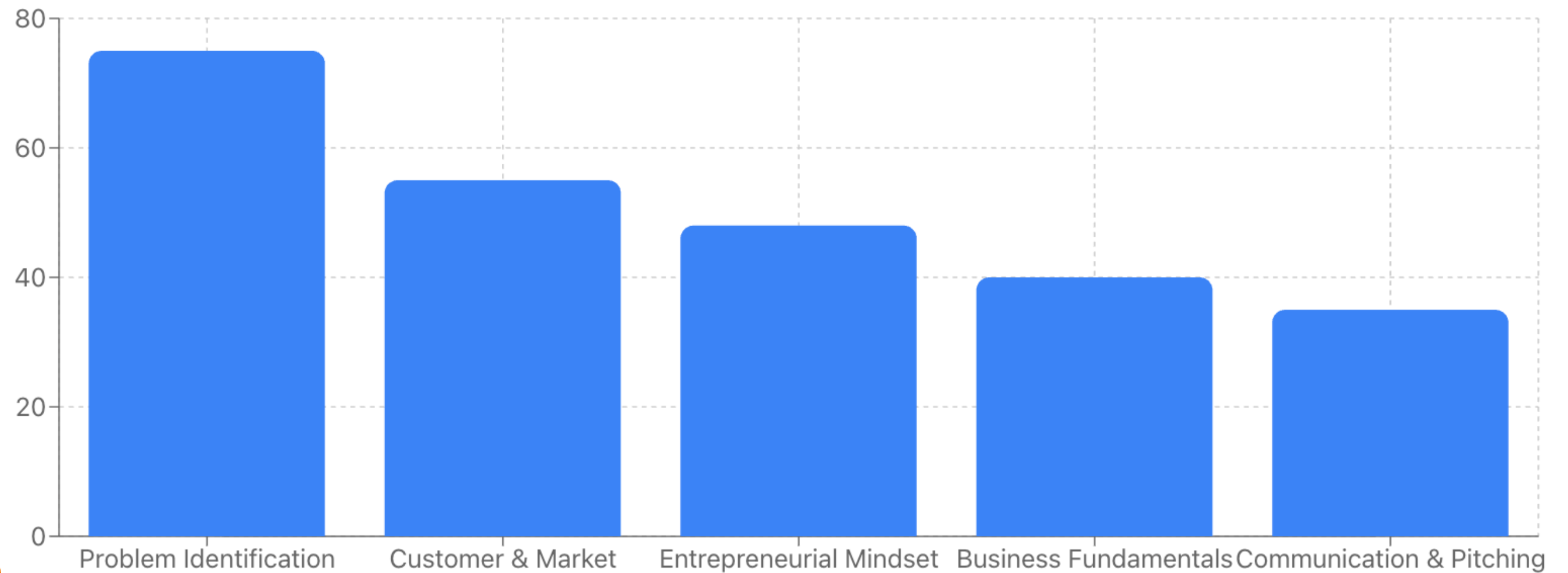
62% from Engineering (CSE/AI&ML/ECE) | 38% from Non-Tech

Your learnings from EIE1



Top Learnings from CIE

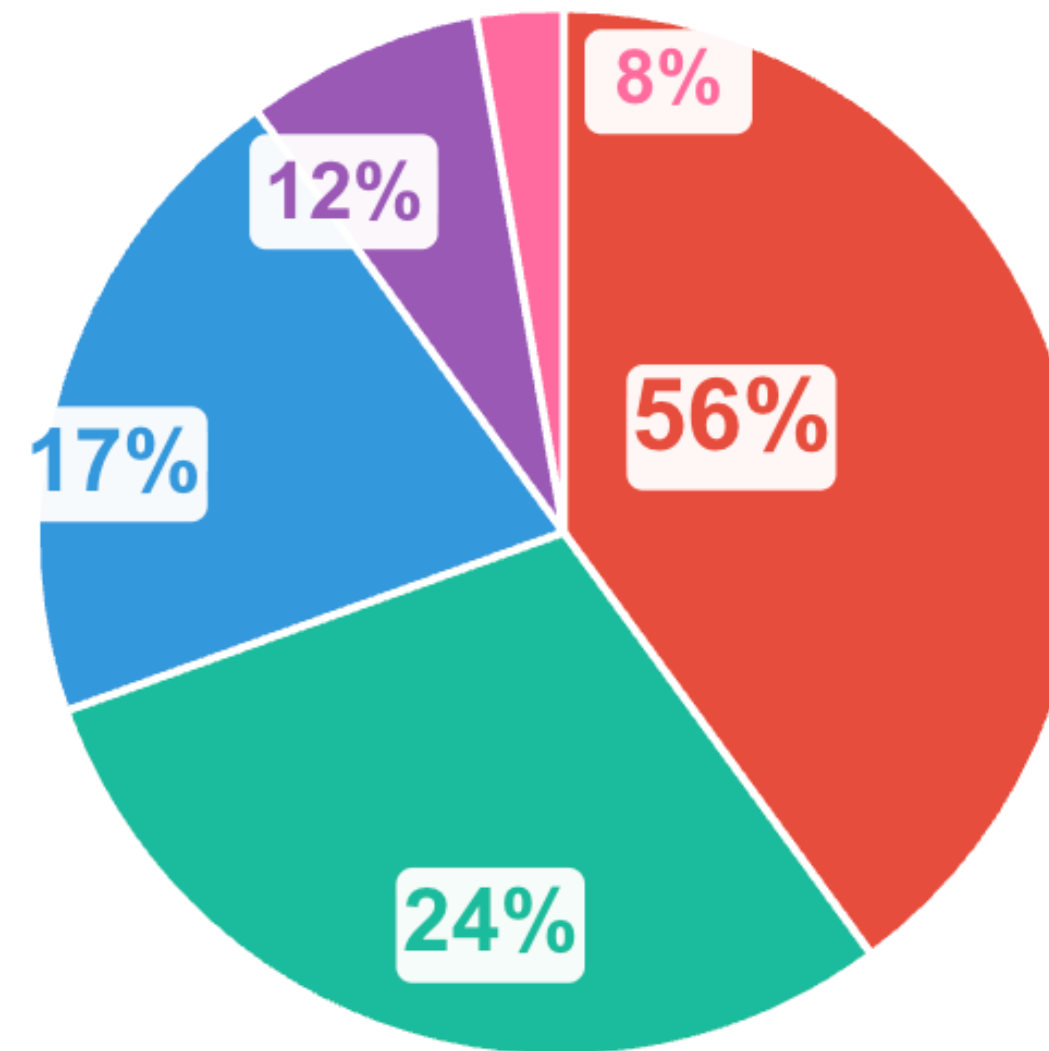
Most Frequently Mentioned Takeaways



Have you applied what you learnt?

⚠ The Application Gap

Have Students Applied What They Learned?



Plan to Apply (Not Yet) (56%)

Applied in Hackathons (24%)

Applied in Projects (17%)

Applied in Internships (12%)

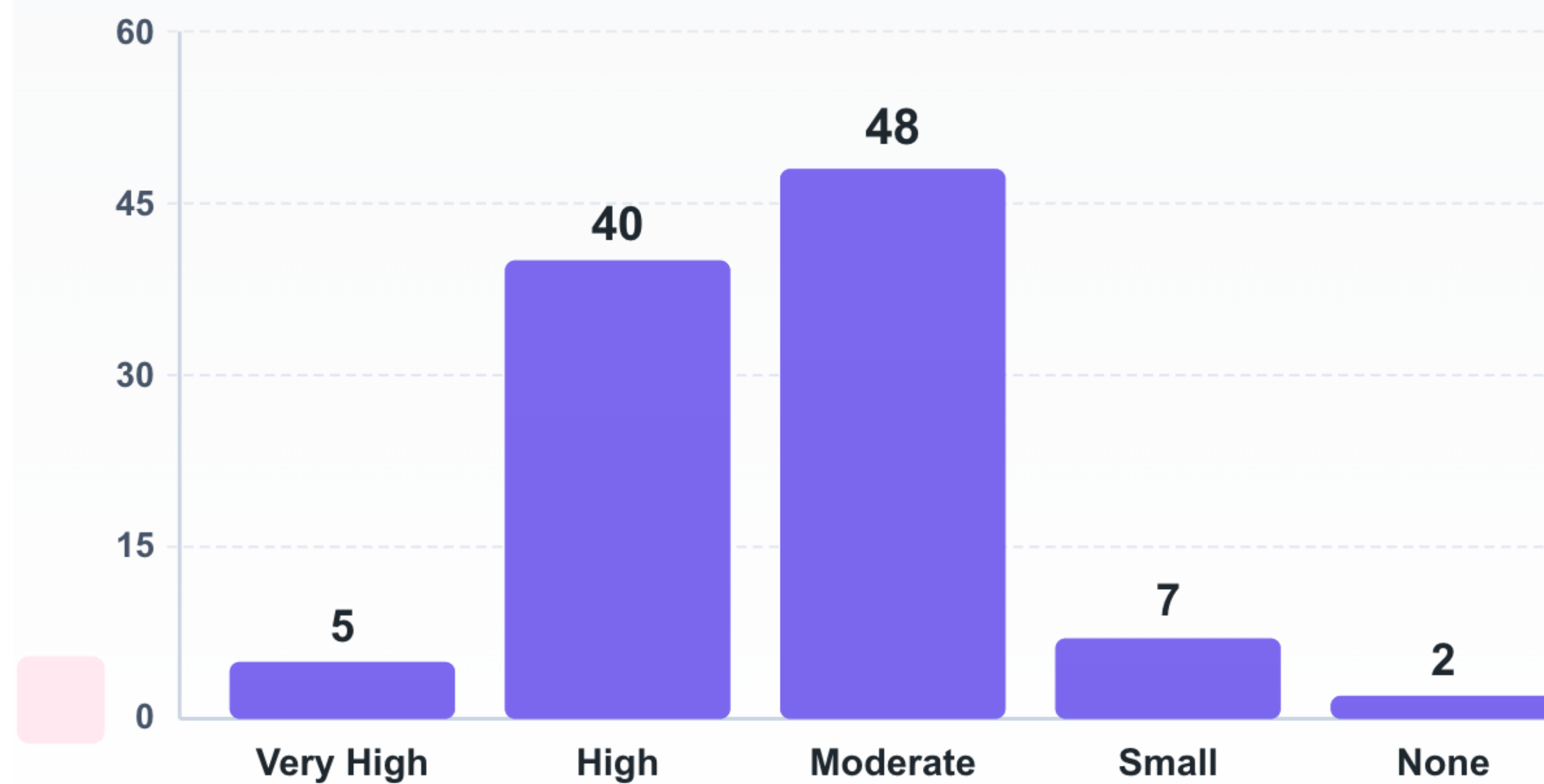
Unsure How to Apply (8%)

EIE Impact



Overall Impact Rating

How Much Impact Has CIE Had on You?



88 responses • 88% reported Moderate to Very High impact

EIE1 – Strengths and Gaps



Course Effectiveness Across Dimensions

Strengths and Gaps

✓ STRENGTHS

Innovation Thinking

85%



Engagement

75%



Career Shaping

70%



⚠ GAPS TO ADDRESS

Practical Application

60%



🔴 Critical: Students struggle to implement learnings

Content Depth

65%



Need deeper dive into fewer topics

Overall Signals



Theme for EIE2 – H1 2026



Engage Better

Request – Student Volunteers



<https://forms.gle/4AHHohNhhMDGoxWy6>



Let us Play – Signal OR Noise



At **CES 2026** (A Tech showcase event, Las Vegas - Jan 2026) wearable AI gadgets focused on lifelogging and personal assistance were highlighted as a standout category, with major companies (*Meta, Amazon, OpenAI* and newer startups) showing prototypes and early products.

Multiple startups unveiled wearable AI devices that record and summarize daily life (audio, visual, contextual data), helping users capture memories and automate routine tasks. Investors are pouring early capital into this space, and some product makers are already doing early consumer testing.

Your Turn: Signal vs Noise Question:

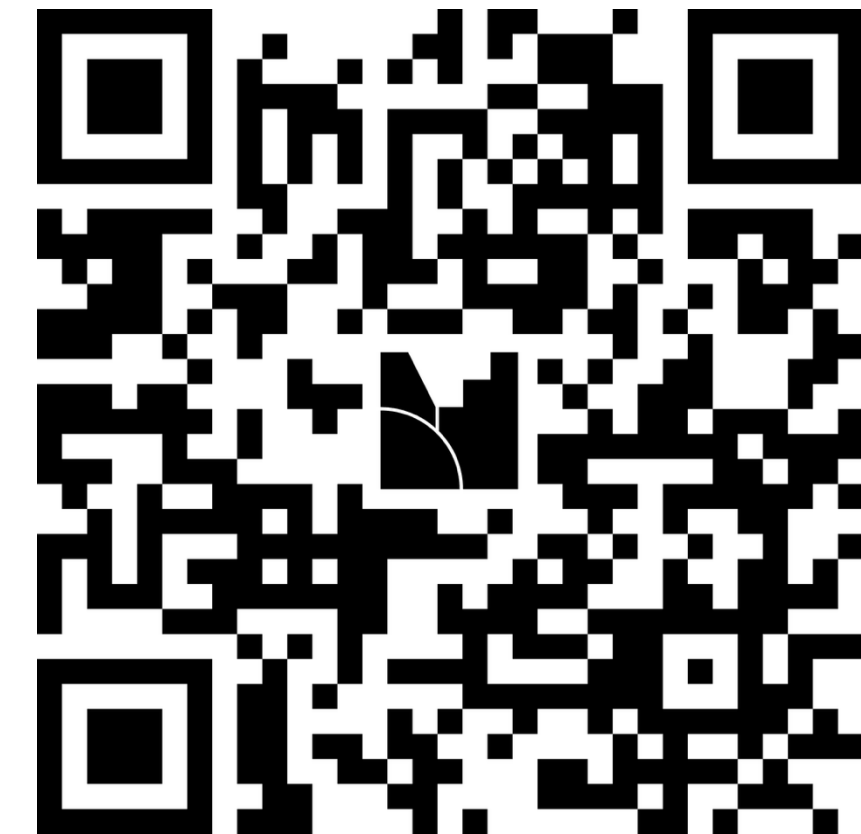
**Is wearable AI a real customer need that will scale or hype that may not stick with real users?*

You Vote using the Menti

Signal: strong market need

Noise: temporary buzz

Menti: 6844 9636



Why Startups Fail and What Can You Do Differently?



What is a Startup?

A startup is a temporary organization designed to search for a repeatable and scalable business model



Why startups fail?

Most Startups want to build this



Why startups fail?

First build this....

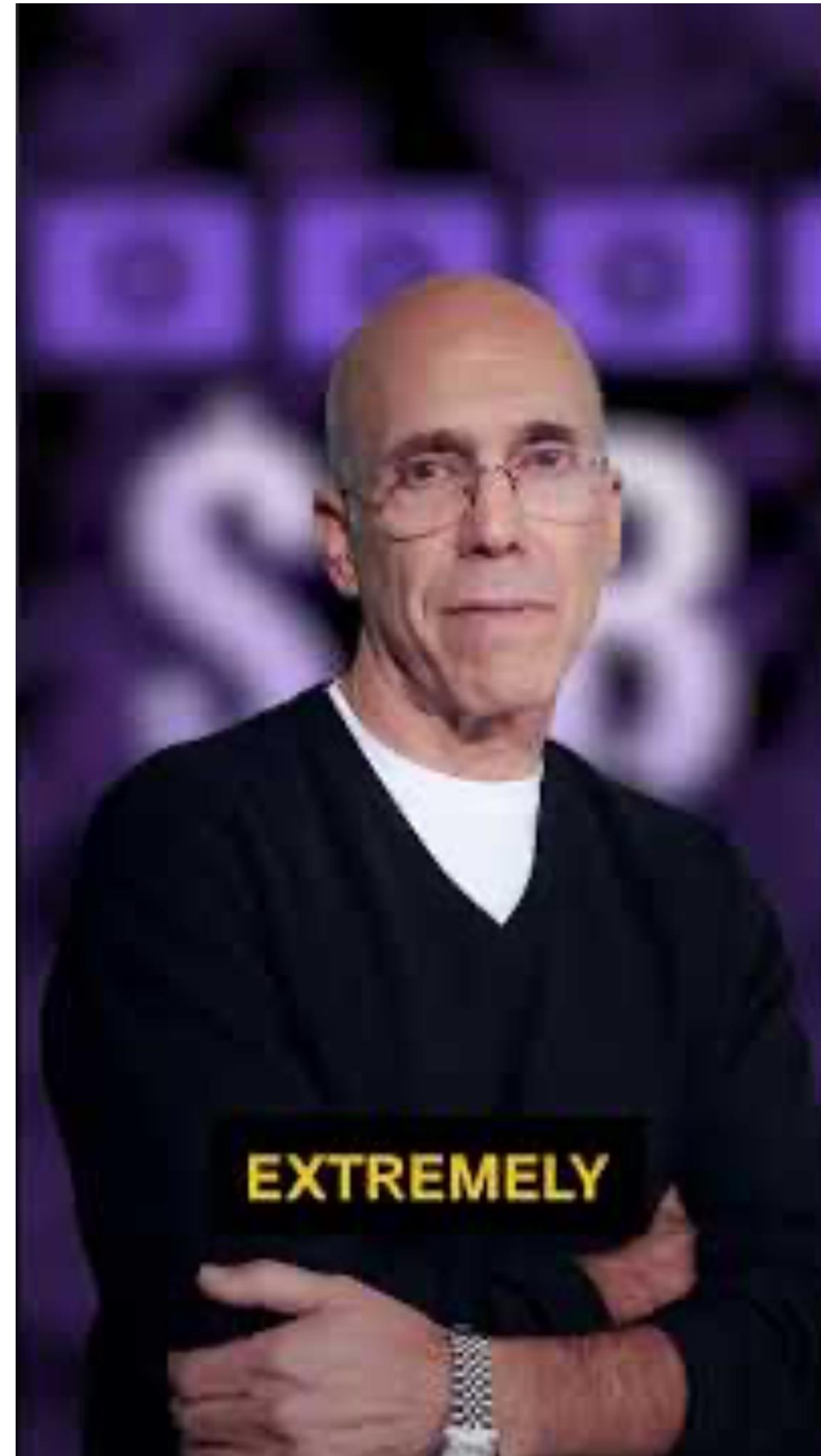


Why startups fail?

And Eventually Build this ...



Let us look at Quibi



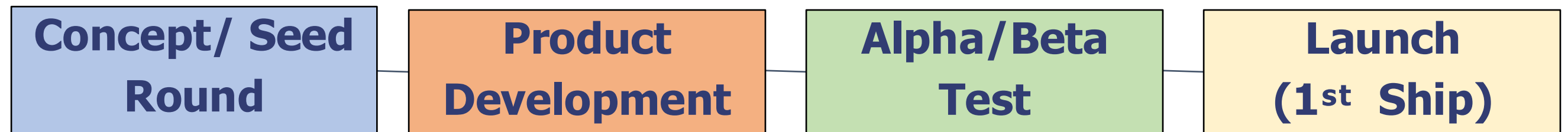
Ref:
<https://www.youtube.com/shorts/rJyqYxeQtY0>

Remember this from EIE1?

Top reasons startups fail



Conventional Approach: Product Development Model



Conventional Approach: Product Development Model

Marketing	Create Market Collateral Create Positioning	Hire PR Agency Early Buzz	Create Demand Launch Event “Branding”
Sales		Hire Sales VP Hire 1 st Sales Staff	Build Sales Organization
Business Development		Hire First Bus Dev	Do deals for for/past launch

Does this Model work? When? Why? Why Not?

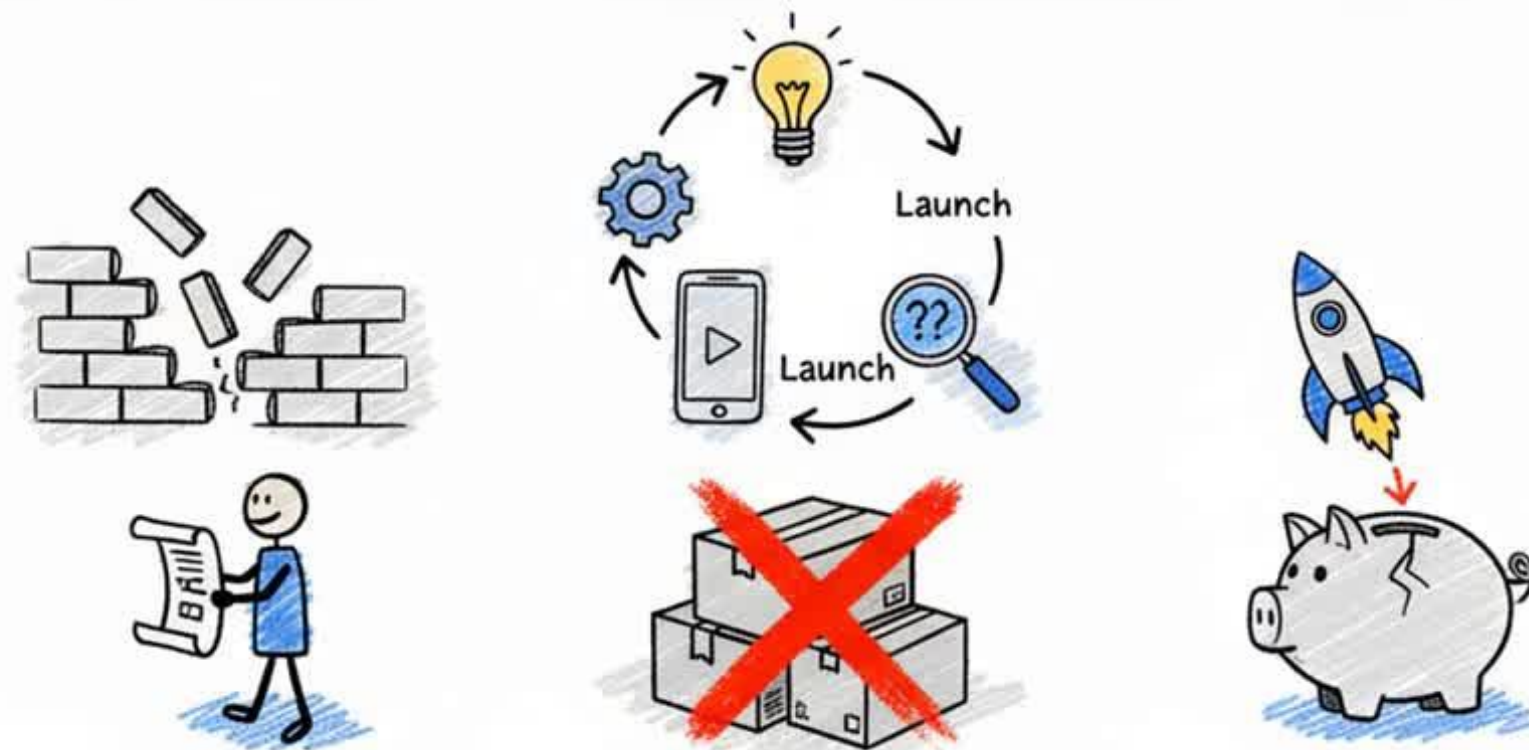
Conventional Approach: Product Development Model

- Business Plan First (BIG assumption: Customers + Market available/ready)
- Startups $\neq$ Smaller version of large companies
- Linear Process
(Idea -> Team -> Product -> Market/Sell -> etc)
- Product Development First (Tech above all else)
- Followed by Test (alpha/beta)



Conventional Approach: Product Development Model

Conventional Product Model



More Startups Fail from a **Lack of
Customers** than from
a Failure of Product Development

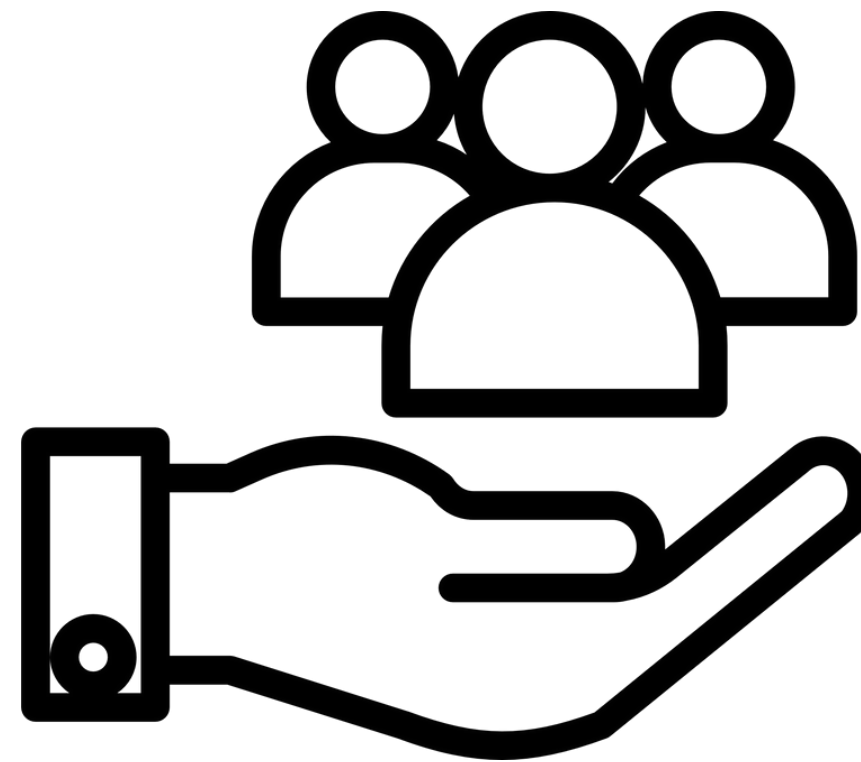


How Do You Fix This?

Focus on Customers and Markets from 'Day 0'

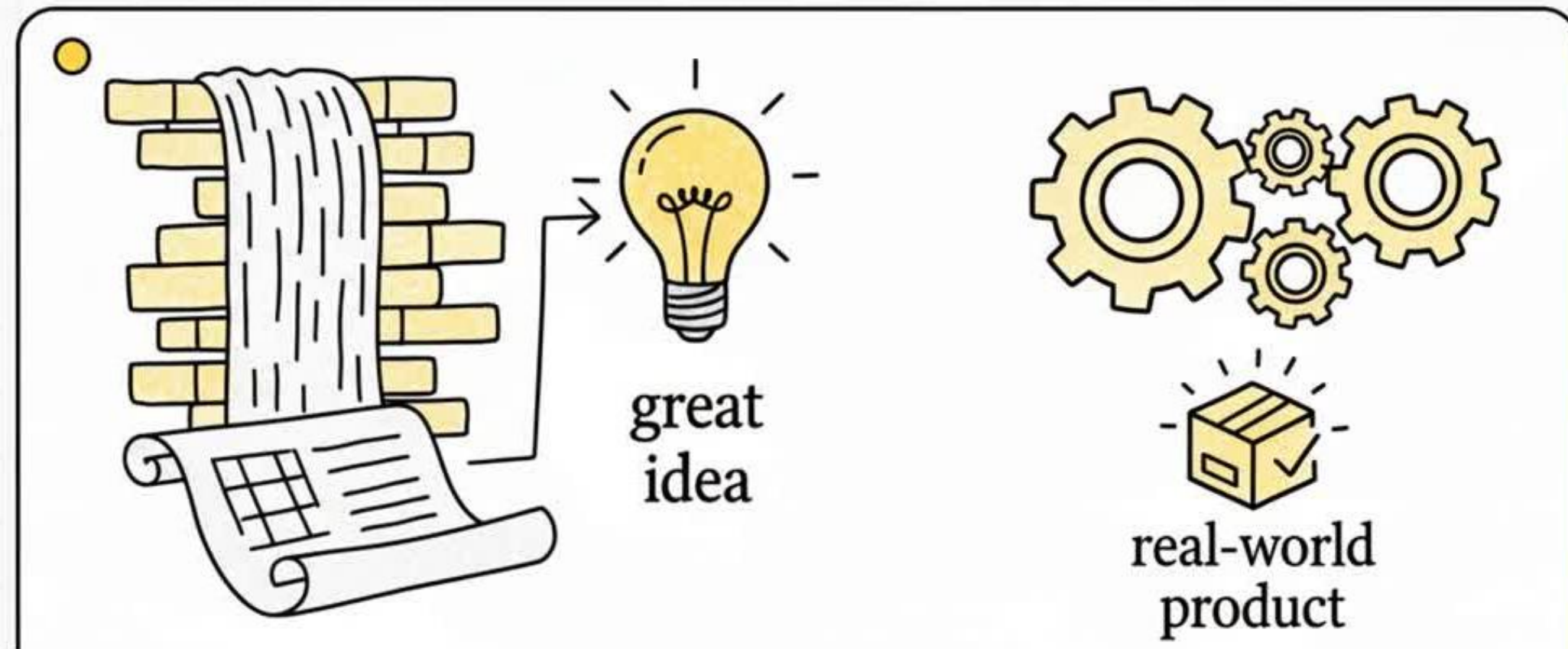
by adopting

'Lean Startup Method'



Required Reading/Viewing

Classic Startup Playbook



Required Reading/Viewing

- **The Lean Approach – Introduction**

(<https://youtu.be/vyR1JjS1Duc>) (Steve Blank, 1:05 mins)

- **The Lean Method**

(<https://youtu.be/GPQExuB-lWw>) (Steve Blank, 5:20 mins)

- **Customer vs Product Development - How to Build a Startup, Steve Blank**

(https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=f_LNNnNfpp4&feature=youtu.be)

Lean Startup Components

**Business
Model
Canvas
(BMC)**

+

**Customer
Development**

+

Agile

Lean Startups Principles

THIS

- 1st Step: Customer Development
- Startup = Temporary Search Organization
- Iterative Process
- Minimum Viable Product (MVP)
- Is there a viable Business Model? Scalable?

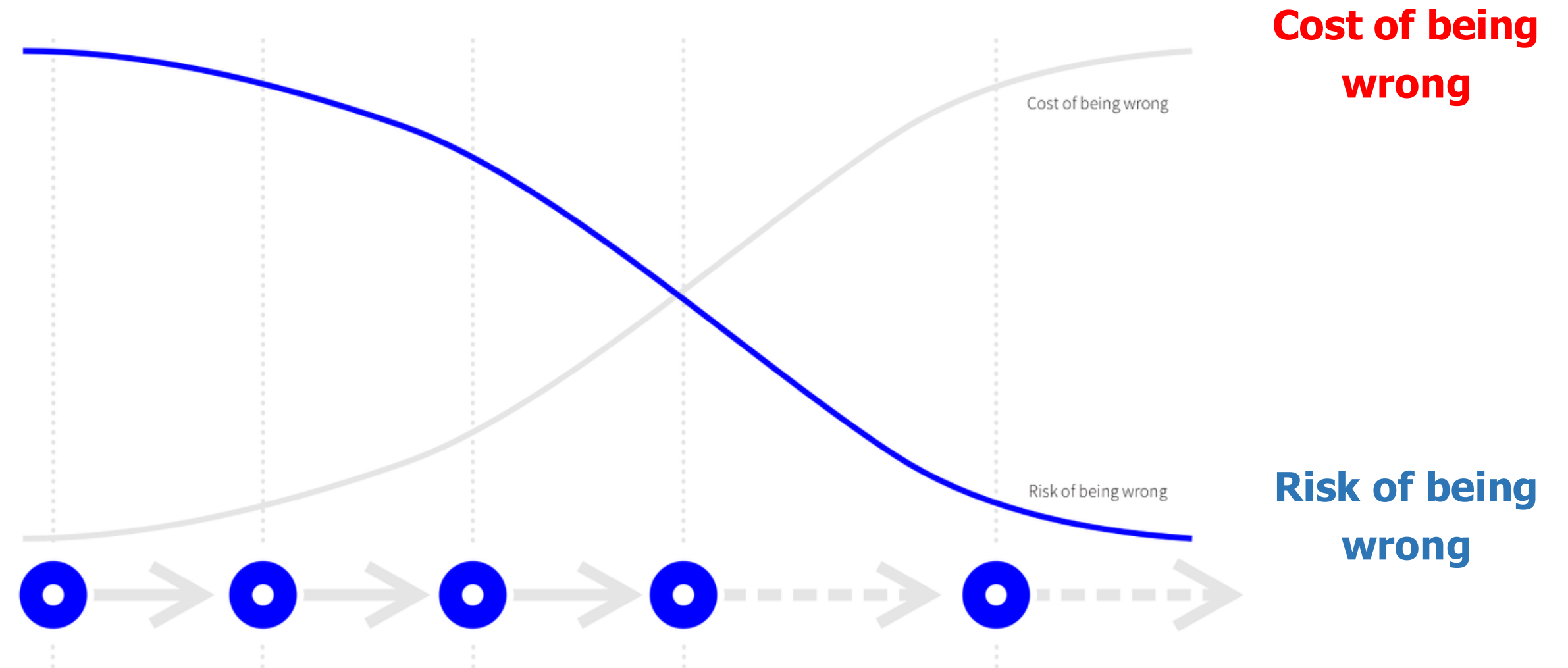
~~NOT THIS~~

- ~~Business Plan First~~
- ~~Startups = Small Companies~~
- ~~Linear Process~~
- ~~Product Development First~~
- ~~Followed by Beta Test~~



Why is this called 'Lean'?

'Lean' (opposite of wasteful) attempts to minimize avoidable 'waste' by identifying risks upfront



Cost vs Risk: '*Cost of being wrong*' keeps growing over time

Lean Startup Components - BMC

Business Model Canvas (BMC) – Prototyping (& NOT Planning) Tool

Key Aspects of BMC

- Desirability:

- Customer Value Proposition, Customer Segments, Customer Relationship, Channel

- Feasibility:

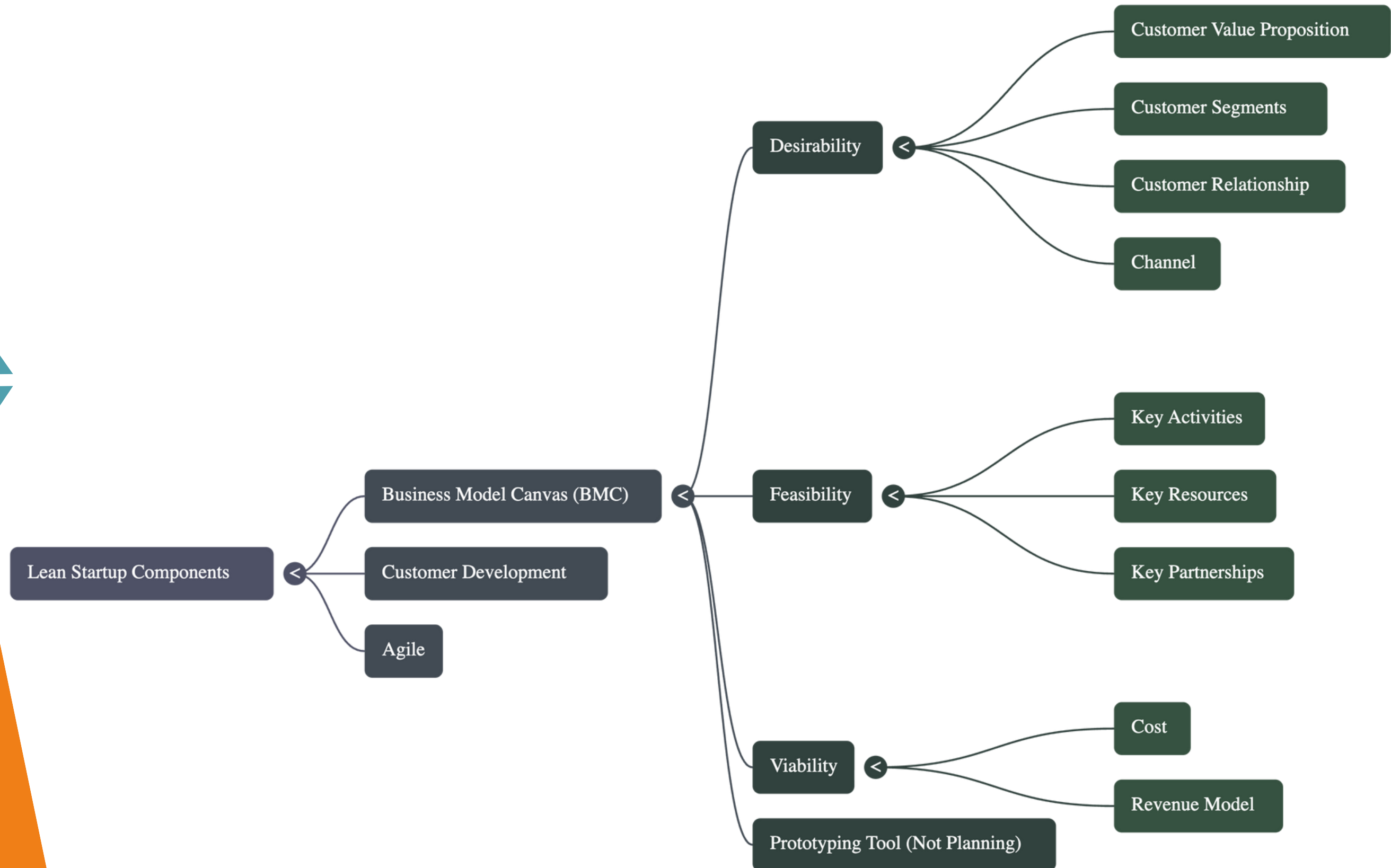
- Key Activities, Key Resources, Key Partnerships

- Viability:

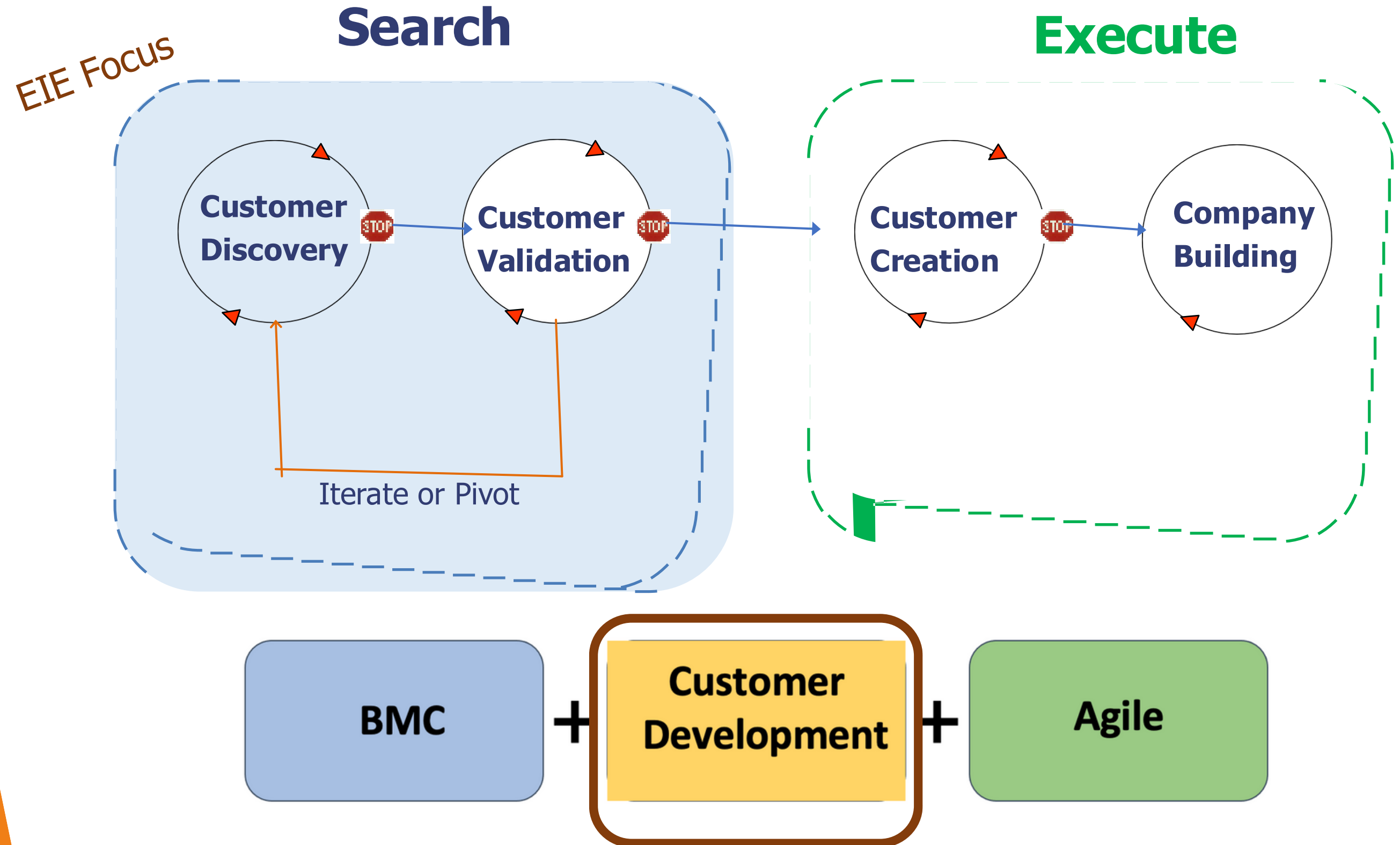
- Cost, Revenue Model



Lean Startup Components - BMC



Lean Startup Components - Customer Development Process



Customer Development Process – Key Points

- Emphasis is on learning & discovery before execution
- Customer Dev: **Parallel process** to Product Development
- Measurable Checkpoints
- Not tied to product schedule, but to Customer Milestones
- Market Type dictates Customer Development process
- “There are no facts inside your building, so get outside”



Agile Development

"Our highest priority is to satisfy the customer through early and continuous delivery of valuable software."

<http://agilemanifesto.org>

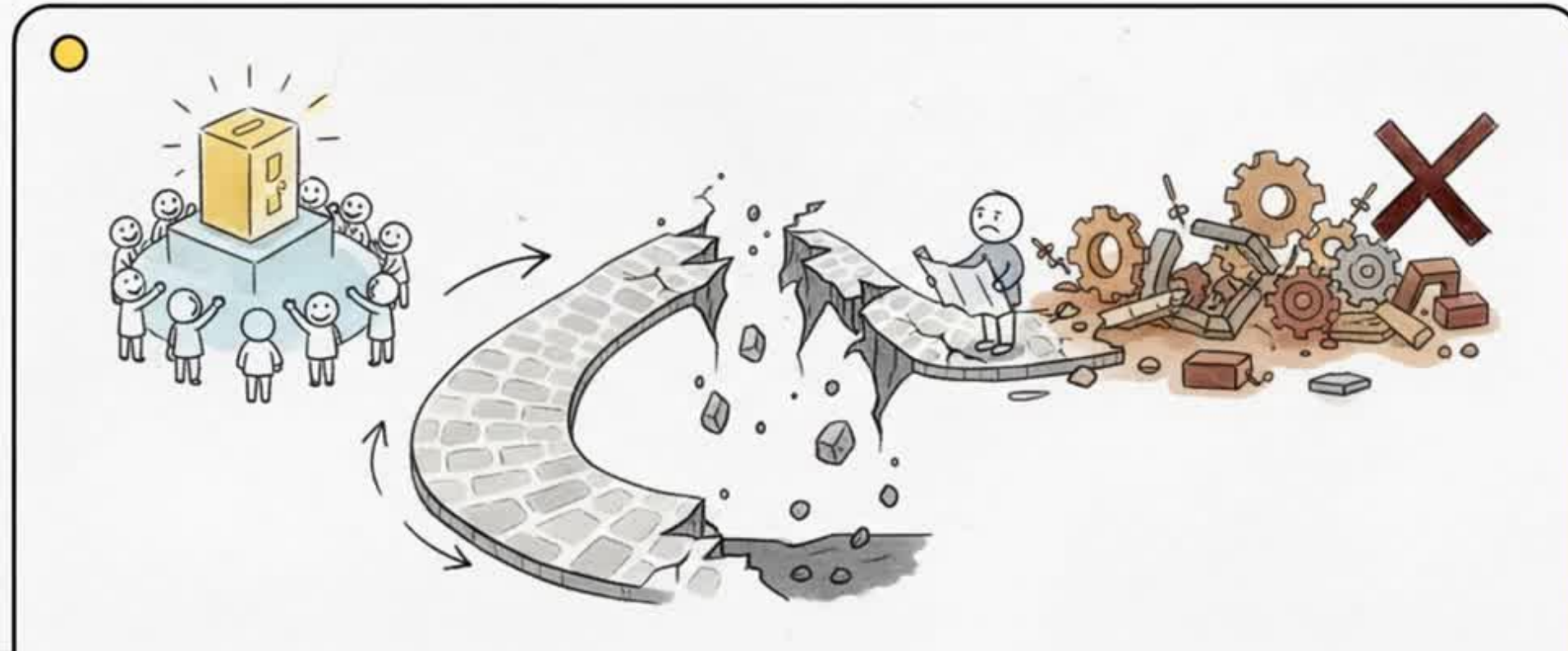


Lean Startup Components – Agile Development

- Prefer flexibility to perfection
 - Ship early and often
 - Test-driven to find and prevent bugs
 - Continuous improvement vs. ship-and-maintain
- Embrace Change
 - Build what you need 'today' (customer-centric)
 - Process-oriented development, so change is relatively painless

Lean Startup Components – Agile Development

The Conventional Product Fallacy



Successful Lean Startups

- A popular team communication and collaboration platform, started as a side project within a game development company called Tiny Speck.
- The founders, Stewart Butterfield, Eric Costello, Cal Henderson, and Serguei Mourachov, initially built an internal tool for their game development team.
- However, they soon realized the potential of the tool as a standalone product and pivoted to focus on building Slack.
- They continuously iterated based on user feedback and market demand, leading to its eventual success.



Successful Lean Startups

- The visual discovery and bookmarking platform, employed lean startup principles in its early stages.
- The founder, Ben Silbermann, started by creating a basic prototype and shared it with a small group of friends to gather feedback.
- He iterated on the product based on user insights, focusing on building a simple and intuitive experience.
- The lean approach helped Pinterest gain traction and refine its features to meet user needs.



Summary

- **Customer-Centric Approach:** Prioritise customer needs over product development. Begin with Customer Development to understand and validate your market.
- **Iterative Progress:** Embrace an iterative process:
 - Idea → Team → Product → Market; continuously improve and adapt based on feedback.
- **Minimum Viable Product (MVP):** Build the simplest version of your product that validates your business model.
 - Test assumptions efficiently.
- **Fail Fast, Learn Faster:** Don't fear failure; it's a stepping stone.
 - Focus on learning from failures and pivoting if necessary.
- **Continuous Improvement:** Embrace change and agility.
 - Develop a process-oriented mindset that fosters painless adaptation.
- **Take Action Today:** Embrace Lean Startup principles to validate your idea, satisfy customer needs, and build a scalable business model. Iterate, adapt, and transform your startup journey.

Module 1: Post Session Brief

**Centre for Innovation and
Entrepreneurship (CIE)**

CIE LEVEL 2 - Building a Lean Startup Required Task - 1

Activity

- Reflect on what kind of teammates you are looking for?
- Scout for potential teammates (each team will have 5-6 members)
- Be ready to discuss what role fits you best (Mkt, Tech, Biz, Prototyping, etc)
 - Opportunity theme(s):
 - What do you/team like/excited about?
 - Is “Desirable – Feasible – Viable”?
 - Can be completed (course requirement) in ~10 wks?

Essentials of Innovation & Entrepreneurship (EIE) - II

Module (M2): Customer Development (CD) Model



For Tomorrow's Innovators

CIE Ignite Season02: A curriculum-integrated innovation program delivering guaranteed engagement with 4,500+ engineering students at their most motivated moment.

From classroom theory to real-world impact!

<https://cie.pes.edu/>



Glimpse of CIE Ignite Season 01 - 2025



Celebrating Innovation at PES - CIE Ignite S01 Grand Finale

With over 3,000 participants and 461 teams, this first edition showcased the extraordinary potential of student-led innovation and entrepreneurship on campus.

Powered By

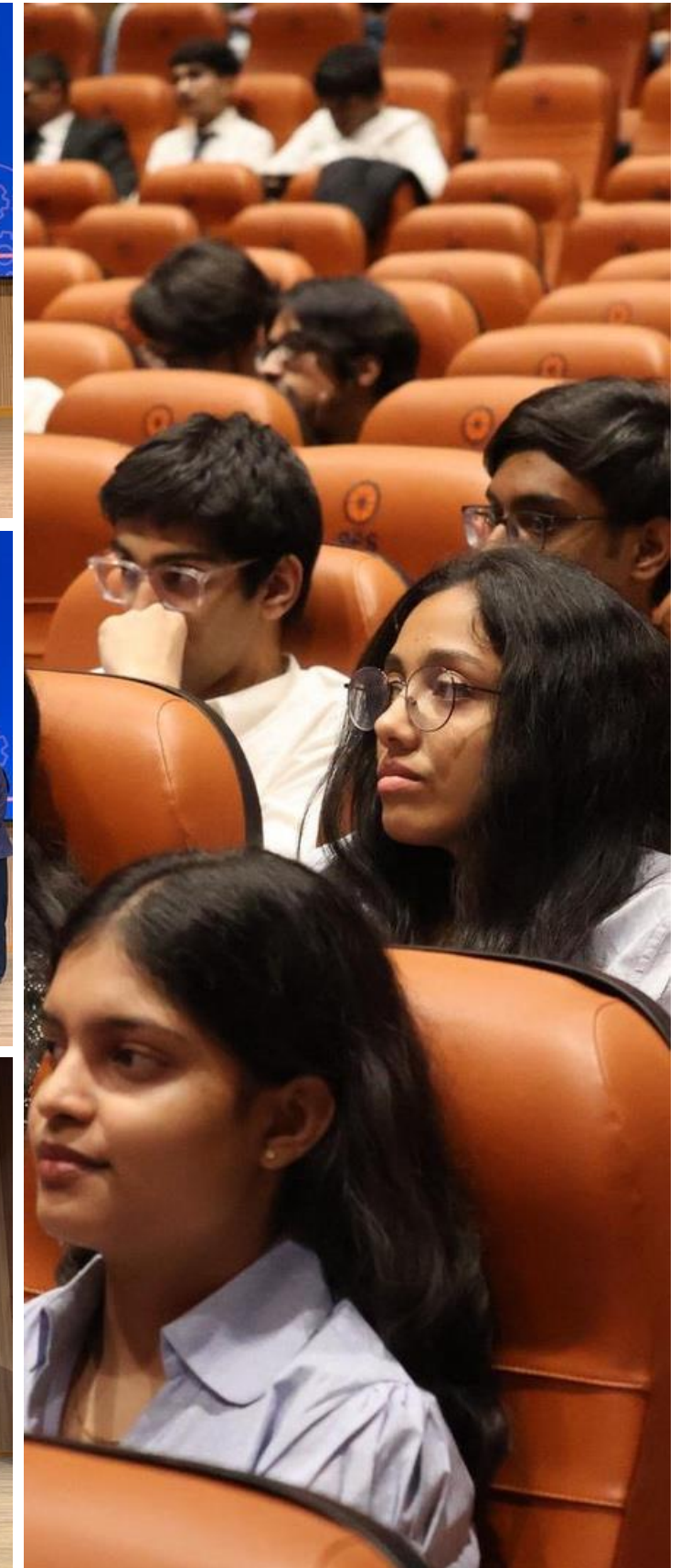
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Nurturing Excellence in Deep Tech



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CS, PESU Bangalore Chapter
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The CIE Ignite Journey



A three-phase innovation pipeline that transforms classroom learning into validated, market-ready solutions

Phase 1: Department Hackathons

January 2026

500+ teams compete across 21 departments. Top 20% advance with validated concepts and initial prototypes.

Phase 3: Grand Finale

March 2026

15 finalists pitch refined solutions to investors, partners, and faculty. Winners announced with prizes and opportunities.

Phase 2: Mentor Sprint

February 2026

60+ selected teams receive structured guidance from industry & alumni experts through two intensive mentorship sessions.

Beyond: Sustained Innovation

April 2026+

Top projects can continue as capstone work, enter pre-incubation programs, or launch as startups with ongoing support.

1

2

3

4

The CIE Ignite Journey



Innovation starts here—and it does not stop.

Season 02 powers ideas into impact:

- Hackathons → Mentor Sprint → Grand Finale → Beyond
- Teams sharpen, validate, and pitch to real stakeholders
- Top projects continue as capstones, pre-incubation, or startups

Be part of the journey:

- Faculty: shape problem statements
- Industry: mentor, fund, and co-build
- Students: bring your best

Let us build market-ready solutions from PES!

Contact: tarunrama@pes.edu

Visit: <https://cie.pes.edu/>



Harvard Manage Mentor program

CIE – Harvard Manage Mentor 2026

“BEGIN YOUR JOURNEY FOR A SUCCESSFUL TRANSITION FROM UNIVERSITY TO CAREER”

Kickstart your career prep and unlock your full potential with Harvard Manage Mentor and more!



Bundle of 6 Topics from Harvard Manage Mentor

- Goal Setting
- Change Management
- Innovation and Creativity
- Strategic Thinking
- Sharpening your Business Acumen
- Presentation Skills



Course Structure

- [A] Asynchronous: Online Anytime, Anywhere !
- [B] In Person: Cafe Session in July/ Aug 2026



Course Certificate

Harvard Business Publishing Certificate
CIE course completion Certificate



Course Duration

Jan 2026 - July 2026

M1 Recap – Quiz

<https://www.menti.com>

Menti Code: 1335 3457



M1 Recap — Why Startups Fail

- Orientation & Course Overview
- Recall - What is a Startup?
- Why Startups Fail
- Traditional Business vs Lean Startup
- Lean Startup Principles
- Business Model Canvas
- Customer Development Process approach



Experiment – Google Classroom

- a. Received 40 Responses
- b. 19 Students with stu.pes.edu Email IDs
- c. 7 Students with pesu.pes.edu Email IDs
- d. stu.pes.edu Email IDs are not able to access Google Classroom. IT is looking into this issue.
- e. pesu.pes.edu Students can access, BUT only 4 of You accessed the Classroom
- f. 1 Student has completed the Assignment – Riya Halbhavi Thank You.
- g. We need more participants, We have reopened the Google Form.
- h. Please Volunteer for the Google Classroom Experiments
 - a. pesu.pes.edu will get access ASAP
 - b. stu.pes.edu please add your IDs and we will get you access soon

Experiment – Google Classroom



The #AI Corner

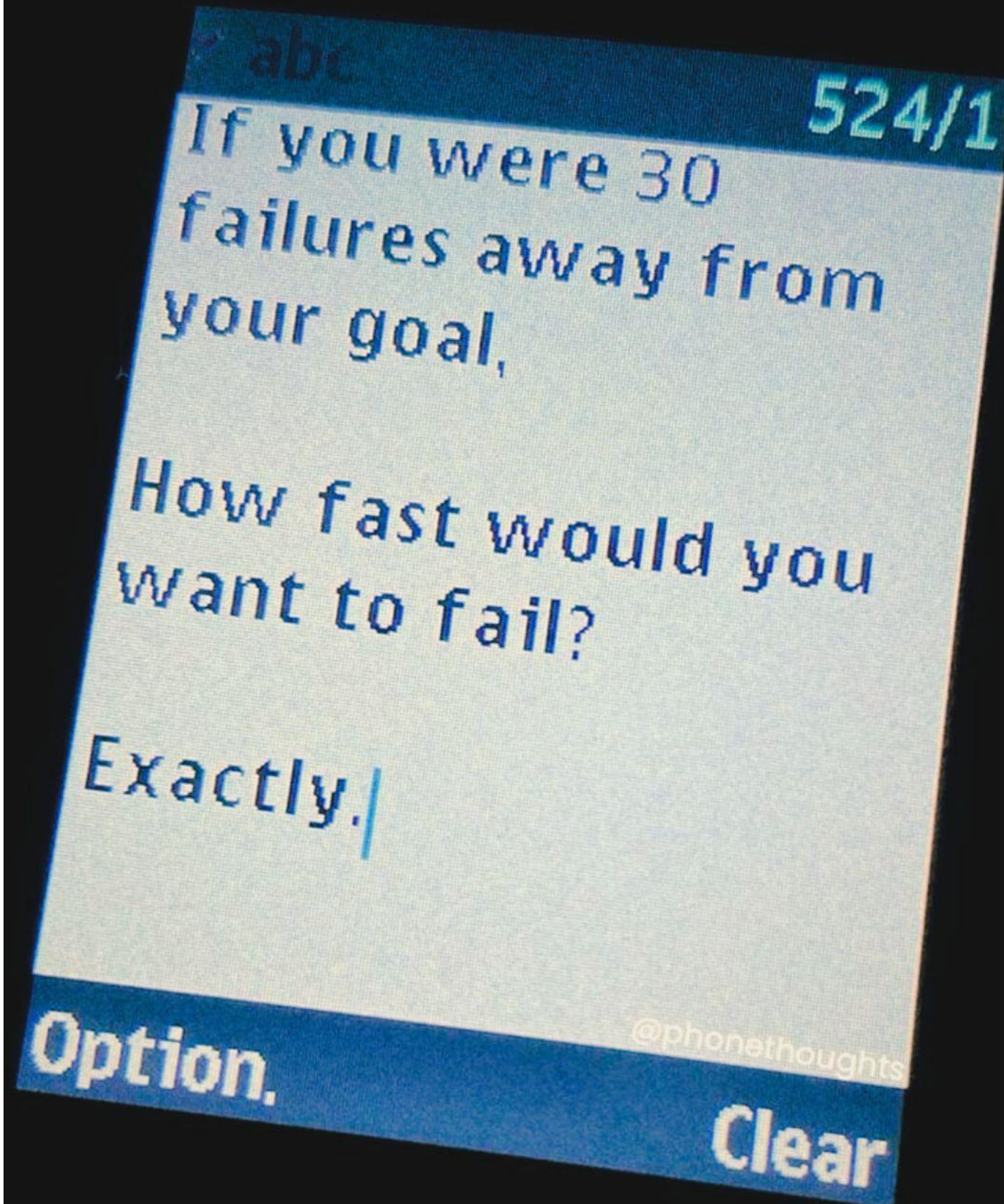
Top AI jobs

Founders

1	 Productivity/decision support	32.9%	
2	 Product ideation	19.6%	
3	 Company vision and strategy	19.1%	
4	Growth & GTM	9.3%	
5	Market analysis	8.0%	
6	Customer research	4.4%	
7	Team communication/alignment	1.8%	
8	Financial modeling/ops	1.8%	
9	Recruiting	1.3%	
10	Status reports	0.9%	

n=225

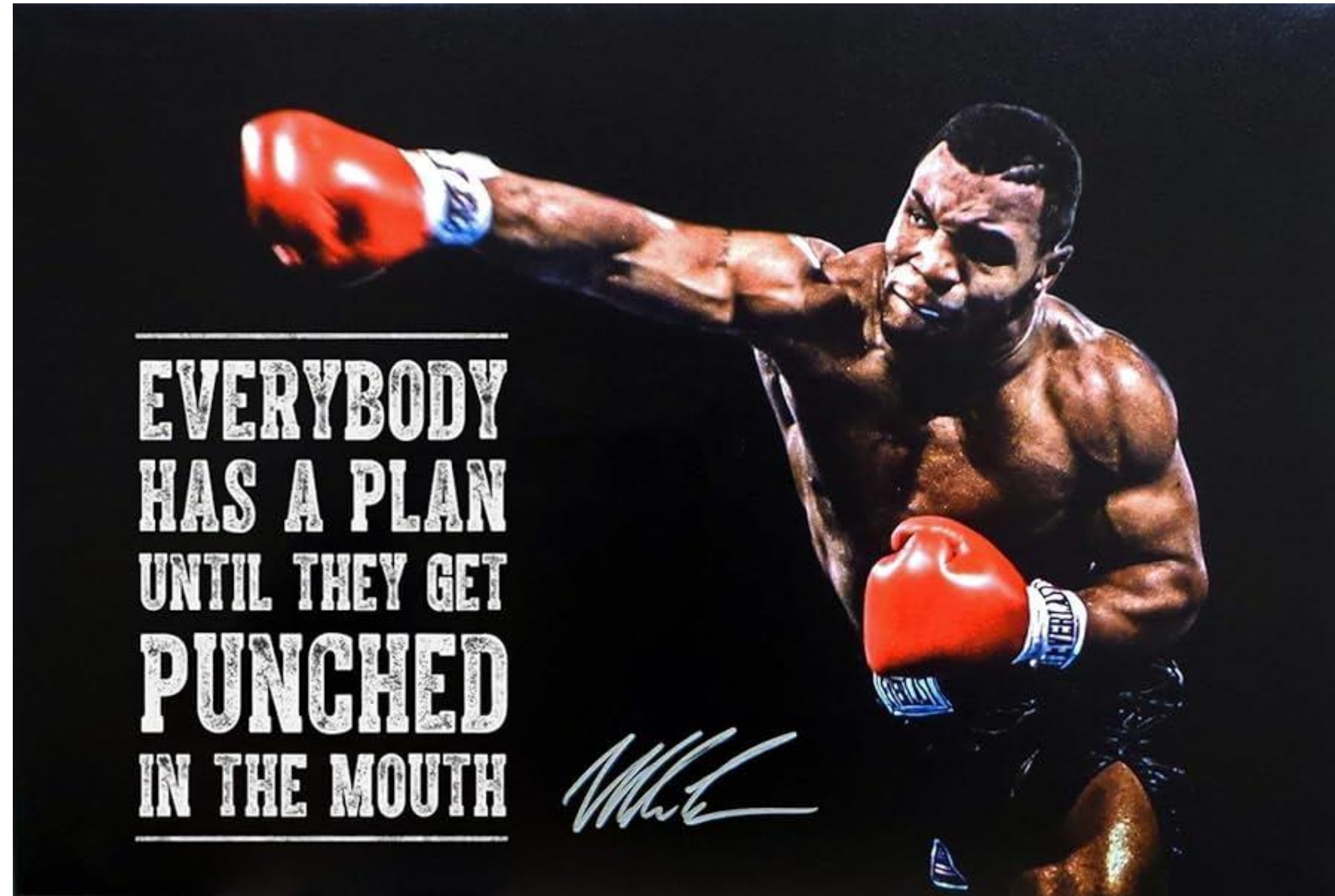
- Founders aren't using AI to *do work*. They're using it to **think better**.
- Their #1 use case is **decision support** — not slides, not code, not docs.
- Other roles treat AI as a tool. **Founders treat AI as a co-founder for judgment.**



Steve Blank, Eric Reis, modern Entrepreneurship

- **Steve Blank is a Silicon Valley entrepreneur and educator** who founded or worked in **8+ startups** across semiconductors, enterprise software, and consumer technology, giving him deep first-hand exposure to early-stage startup failures and successes.
- He is best known for creating the **Customer Development methodology**, which reframed startups as organizations that must **search for a repeatable and scalable business model**, not execute a fixed plan.
- Blank challenged the traditional “build first, sell later” approach by emphasizing **early hypothesis testing through direct customer interaction**—popularly phrased as *“get out of the building.”*
- His work directly influenced **Eric Ries and the Lean Startup movement**, with Ries explicitly crediting Customer Development as the conceptual foundation of Lean Startup practices.
- Leading organizations such as **Intuit and GE (FastWorks)** adopted Customer Development and Lean principles to reduce innovation risk and validate customer needs early, even at enterprise scale.
- The **U.S. National Science Foundation’s I-Corps program** is built on Steve Blank’s Customer Development model, demonstrating its global adoption beyond startups into research and academia.
- Today, his frameworks are widely taught in **universities, accelerators, and corporate innovation programs**, making Customer Discovery a core skill in modern entrepreneurship.

Blank said these (1/3) ...



Business plans rarely survive first contact with customers.

Blank said these (2/3) ...

5-Years Business Plan

			
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No one besides venture capitalists and the late Soviet Union requires five-year plans to forecast complete unknowns. These plans are generally fiction, and dreaming them up is almost always a waste of time.

Blank said these (3/3) ...

What is a startup?

“A startup is not a smaller version of a large company. It’s a temporary organization designed to search for a scalable business model.”

—STEVE BLANK

They do not unfold in accordance with master plans. The ones that ultimately succeed go quickly from failure to failure, all the while adapting, iterating on, and improving their initial ideas as they continually learn from customers.

Customer Discovery Overview

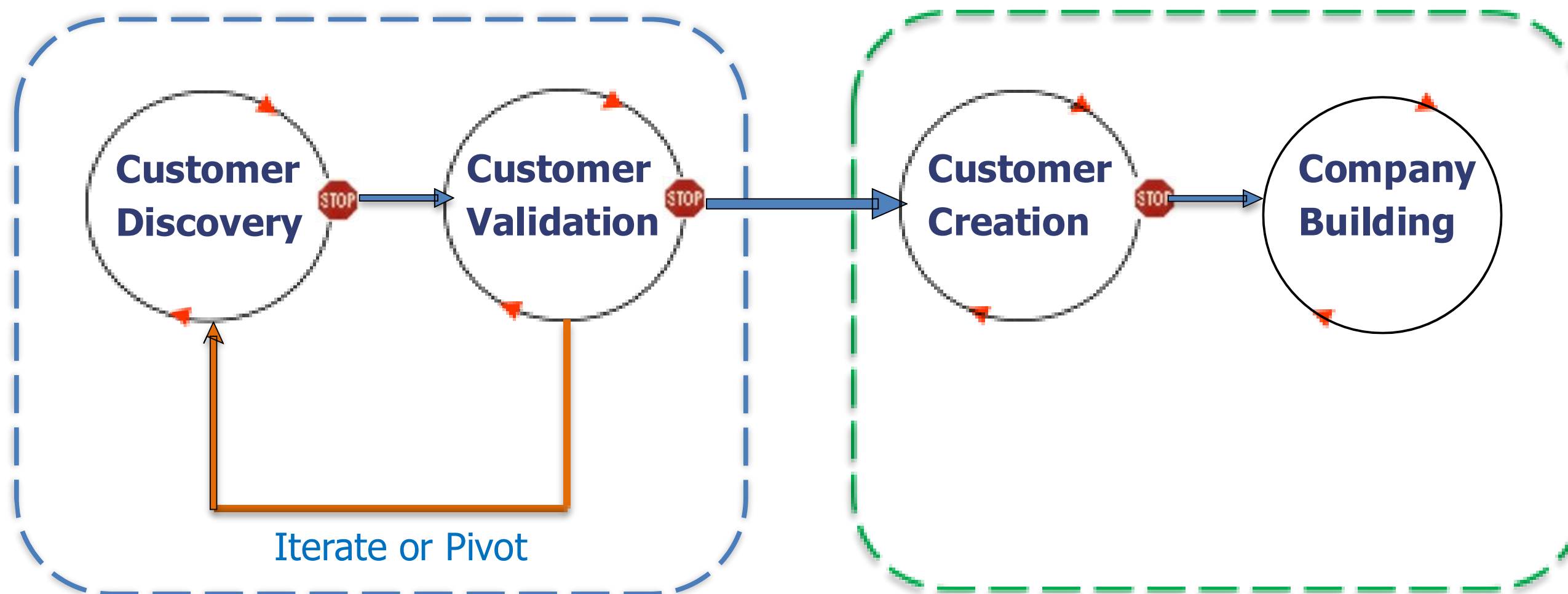
Customer Development



Customer Development Process

“Search”

“Execute”

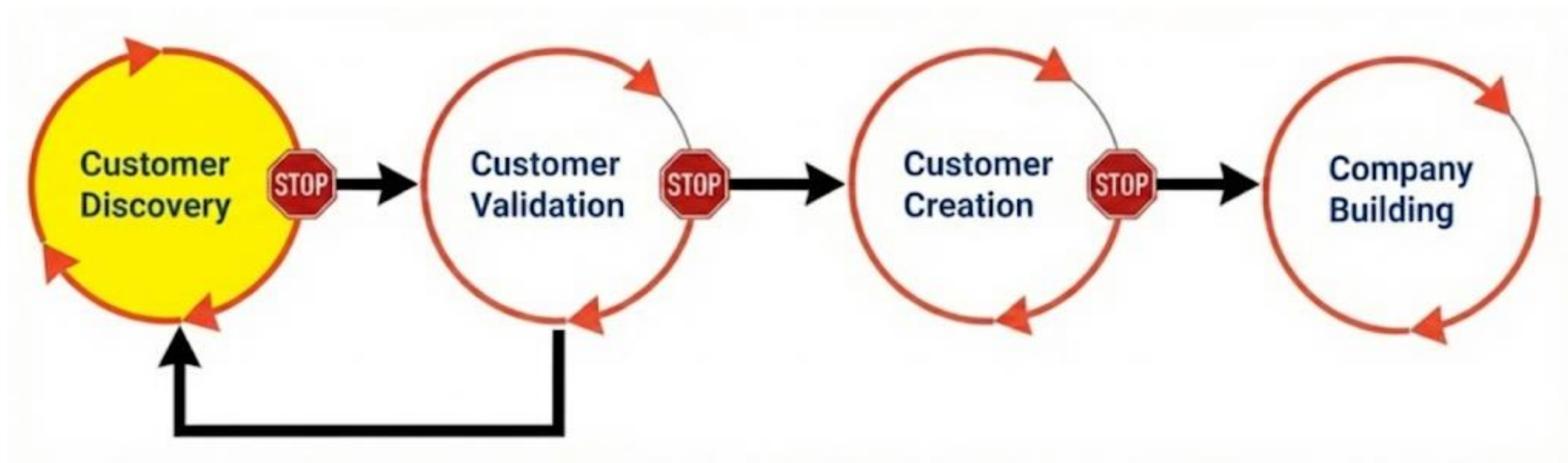


Source: Steve Blank

Video (2:41): [The Customer Development Process: 2 Minutes to See Why](#)

Customer Development

Step 1: Customer Discovery



STOP Selling, START Listening

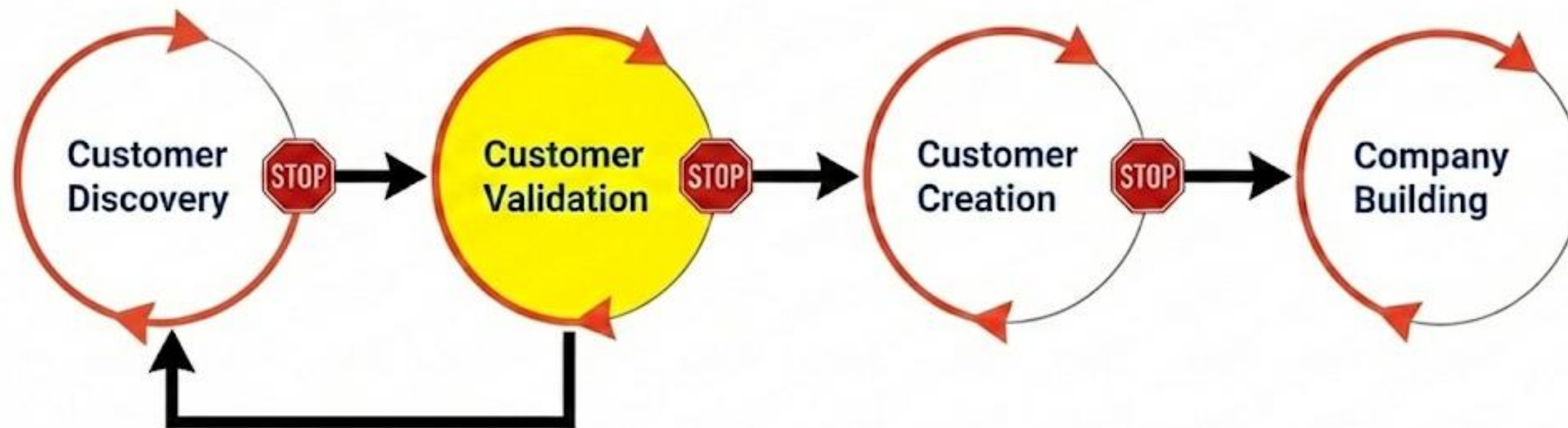
There are no facts inside your building, so **Get Outside of the Building (GOOB)!**

Test your hypotheses

Two main areas: **Problem** and **Solution** (can be either product &/or service) concept

Customer Development

Step 2: Customer Validation

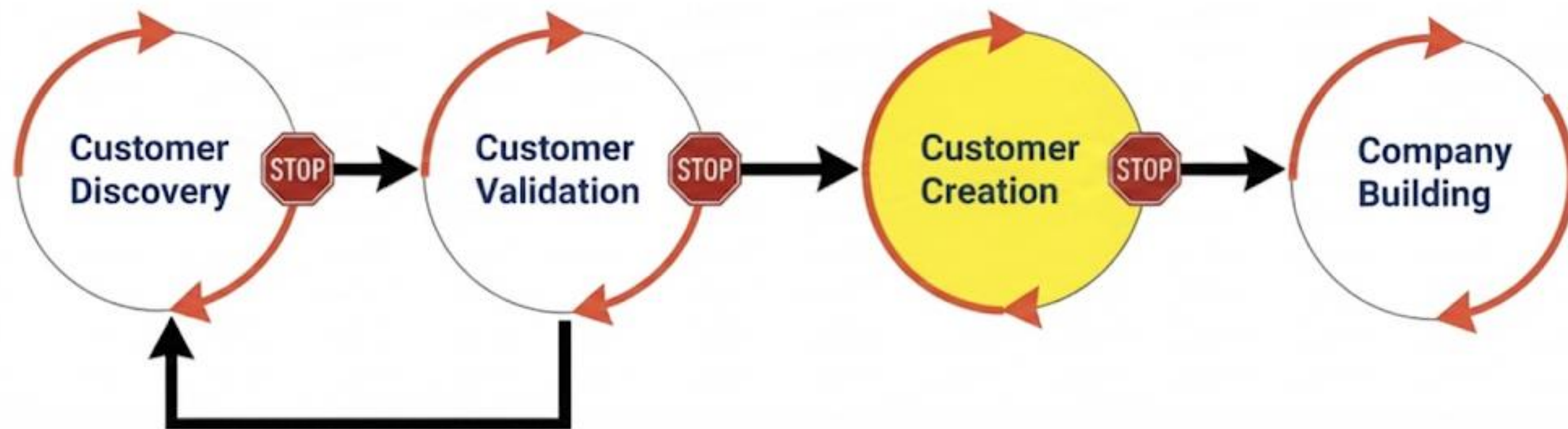


Validate your proposed solution against the Customer's problem(s)

- Is there a "**Product – Solution**" fit? "**Product – Market**" fit?
- Can you develop a repeatable sales process?
- Can you identify "**Early Adopters**" (open to trying out new/ semi-tested solutions)

Customer Development

Step 3: Customer Creation

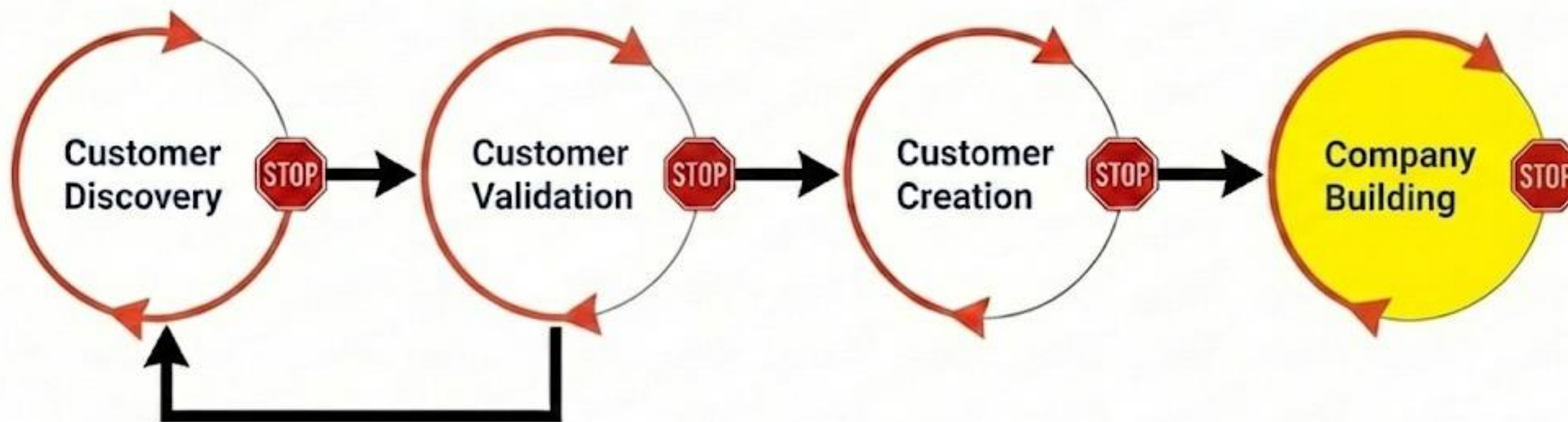


Creation (market/related) comes after proof of sales

- Can you execute your plan with speed and efficiency?
- Don't create something if you can't show sales!

Customer Development

Step 4: Company Building



Start the transition from Startup to a Company

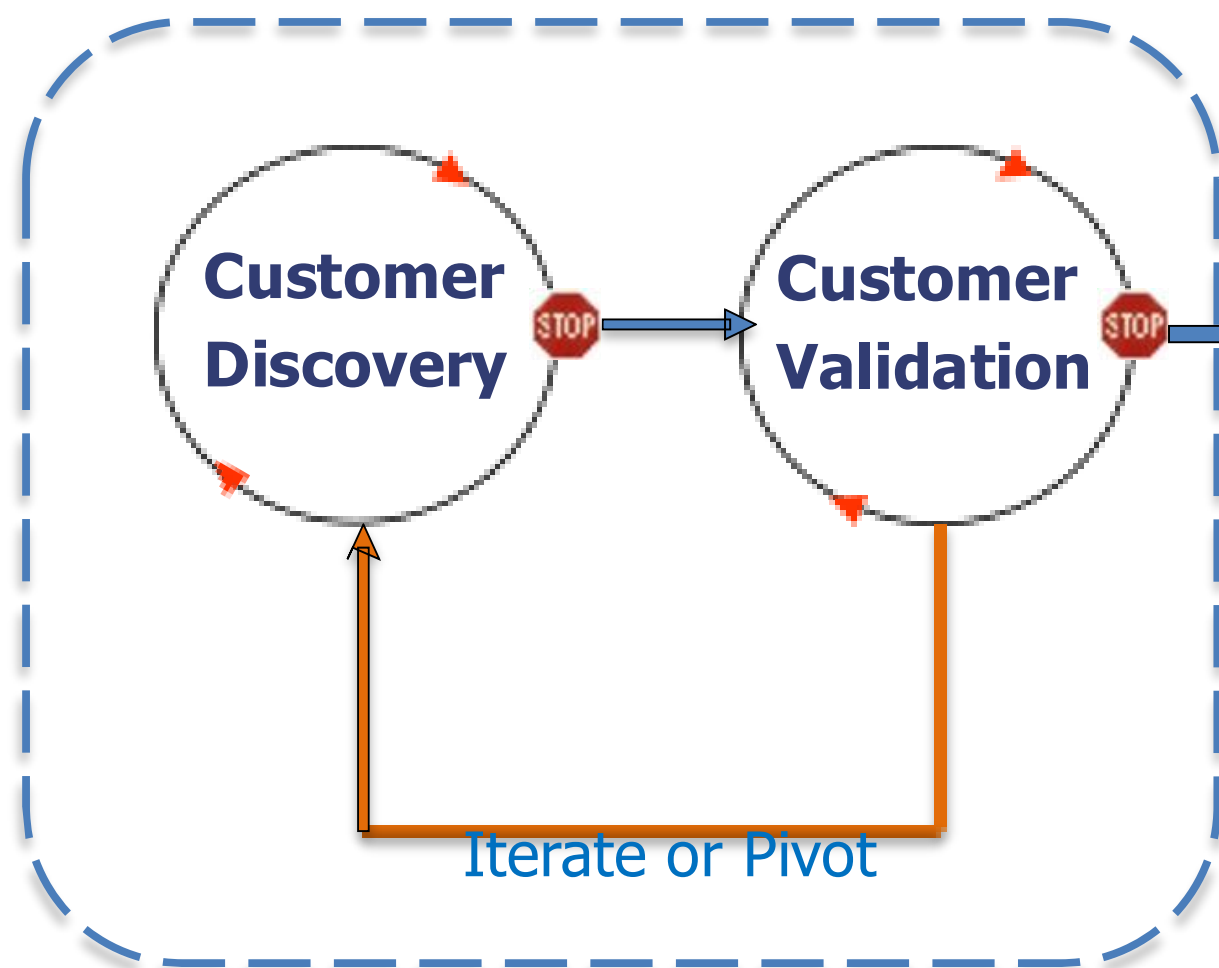
- (Re)build your company's organization & management....Why?
- Re-look at your mission (what got you here may not be sufficient)...Why?

Customer Development

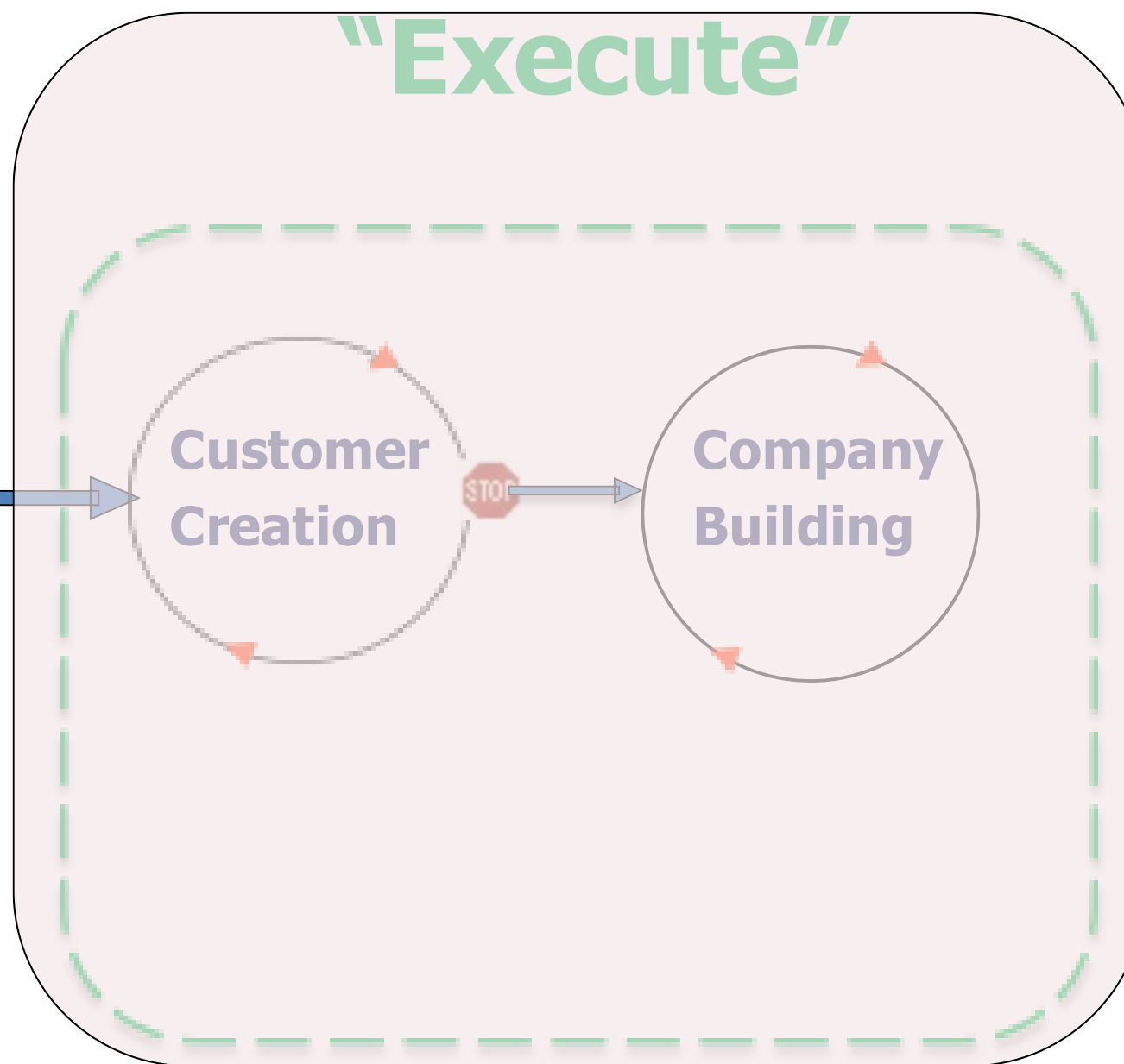


Focus Area for EIE2 & CIE-Ignite

"Search"



"Execute"



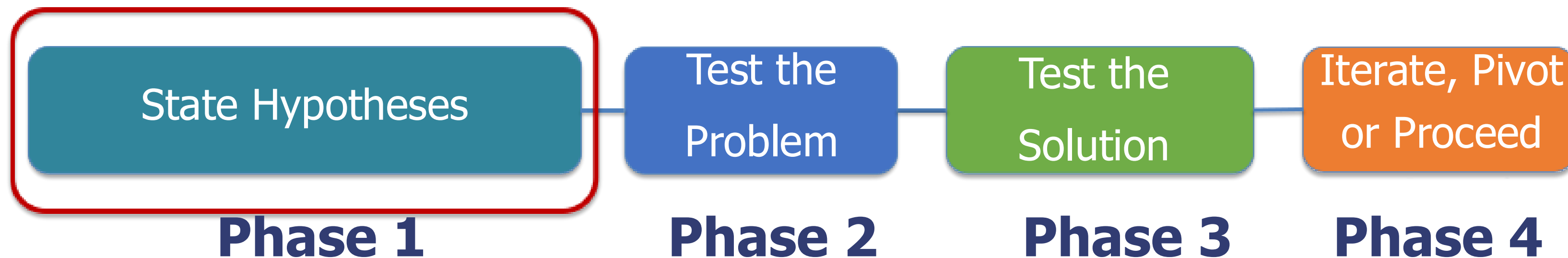
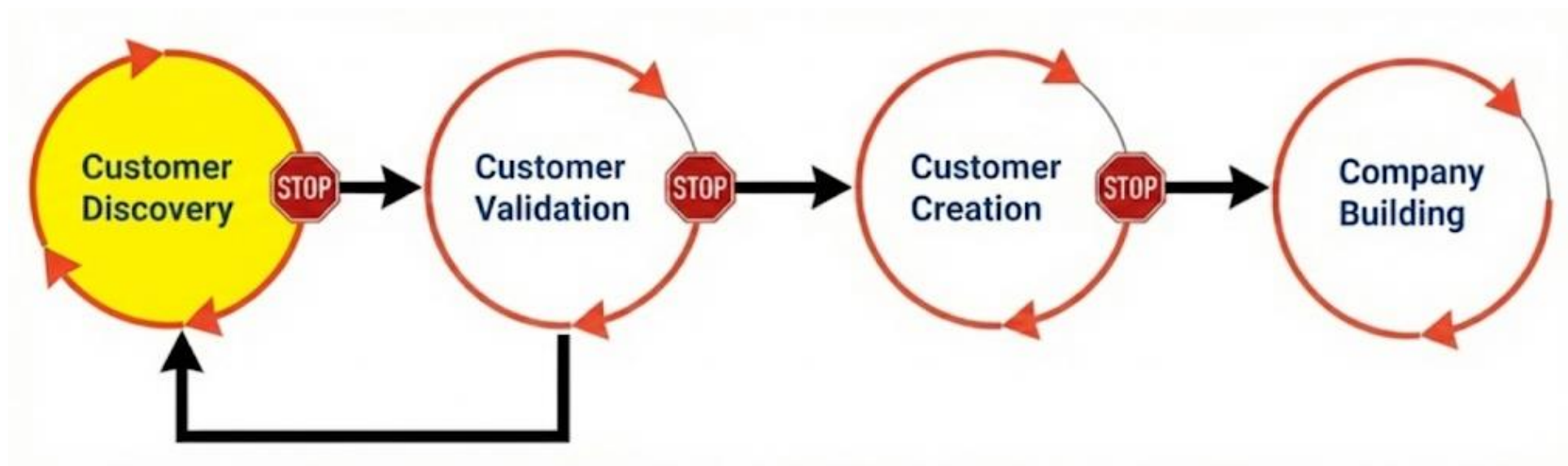
Hypothesis

- A **tentative, testable statement or assumption** made about a phenomenon, relationship, or outcome, which can be **validated or falsified through observation or experimentation**.
- It is formulated **before data is collected**, based on existing knowledge, reasoning, or assumptions, and serves to **guide systematic inquiry**.

Examples:

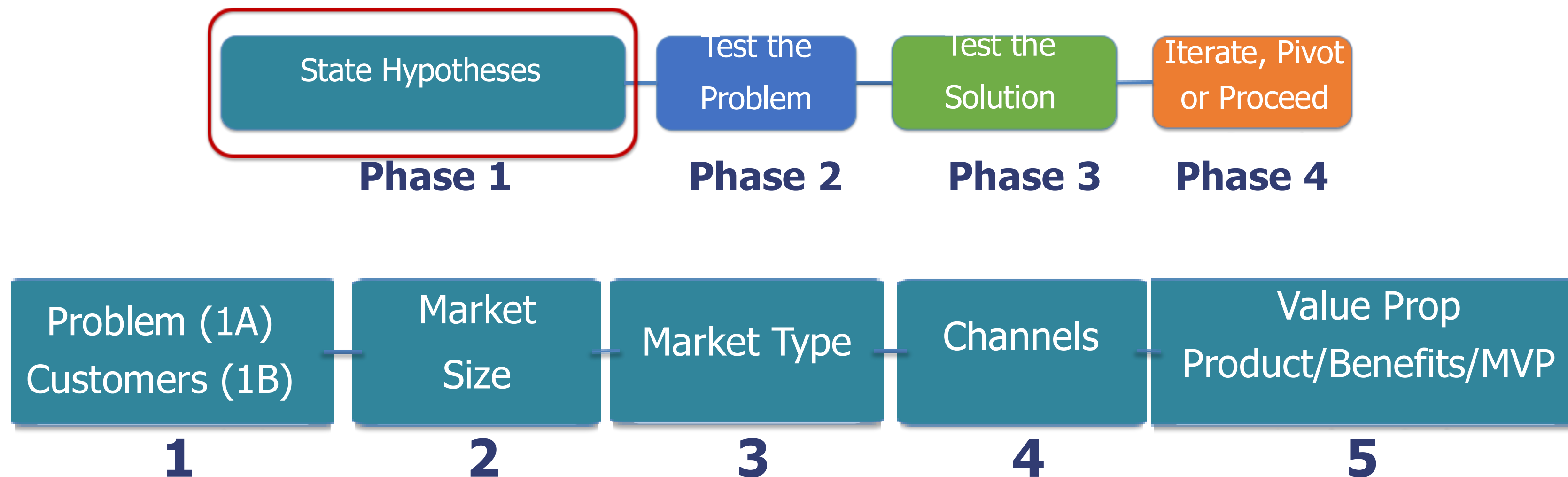
- Sounds Familiar:** "Students who supplement regular course material with 5–7 minute concept videos and audio will perform better in quizzes, ISAs and ESAs than students who rely only on live lectures and standard course material.": **Predicts a relationship between an intervention and an outcome**
- If the college canteen introduces UPI-only fast lanes during peak hours, average waiting time for students will reduce by at least 30%.: **Testable with a measurable outcome**
- "Urban Indian working professionals aged 22–35 prefer ordering groceries via mobile apps rather than visiting local kirana stores at least three times a week.": **Customer behaviour validated through data**
- "In T20 cricket, teams that score more than 50 runs in the powerplay have a higher probability of winning the match.": **Data driven assumption validated by match statistics**

Customer Discovery Overview



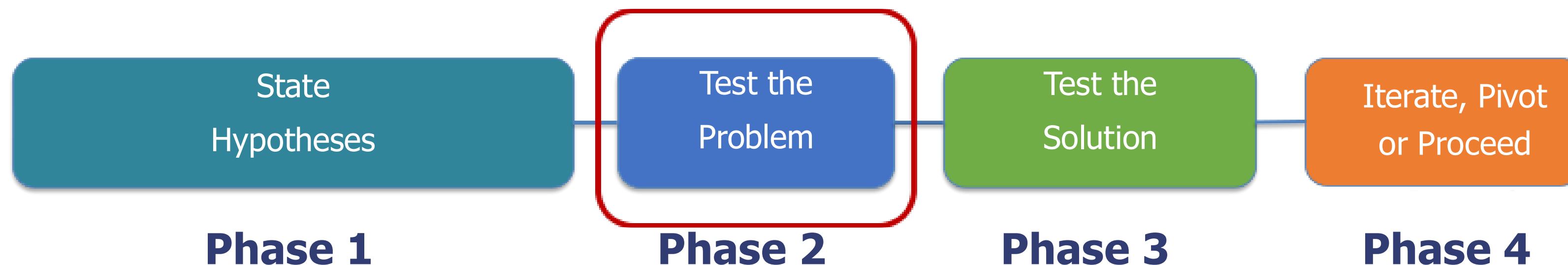
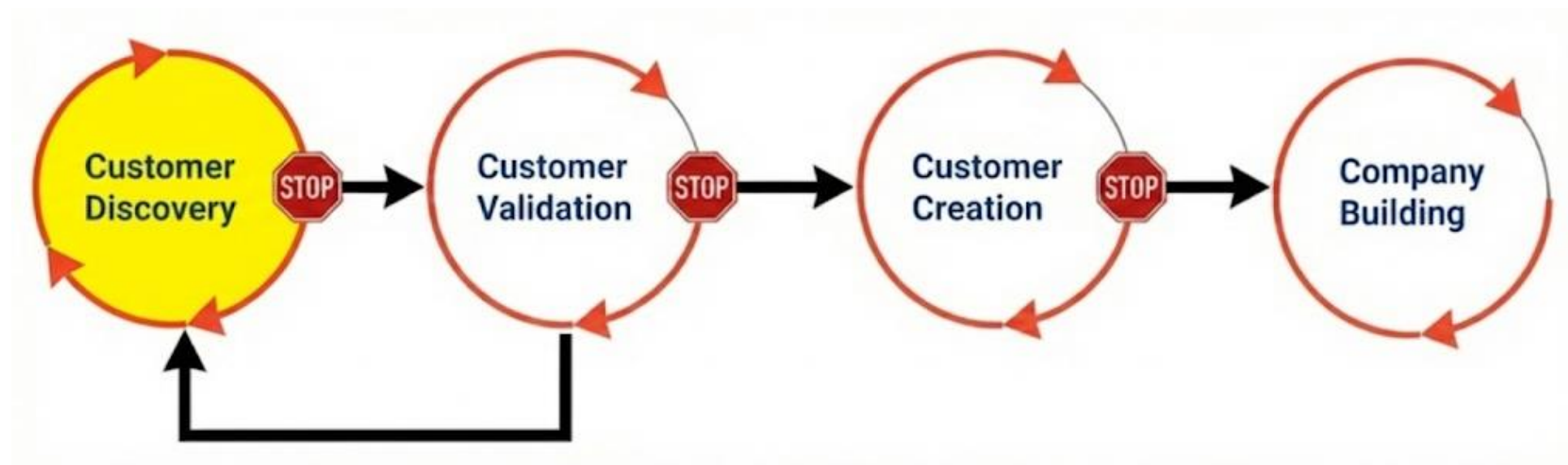
Customer Discovery Overview

Phase 1 : Hypothesis



**Capture your Hypothesis (Assumptions) on a
Business Model Canvas (BMC)**

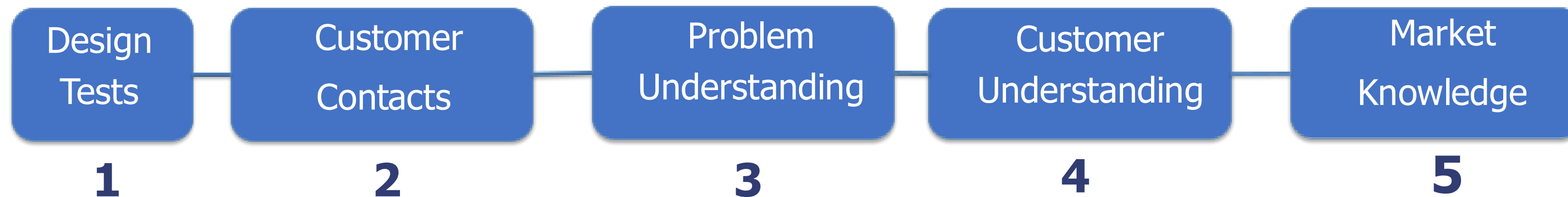
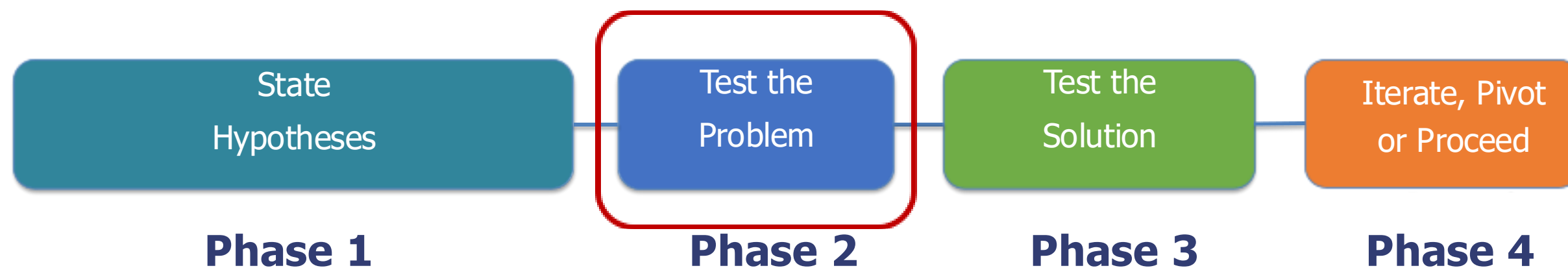
Customer Discovery Overview



Notice that testing the Problem comes before testing the Solution

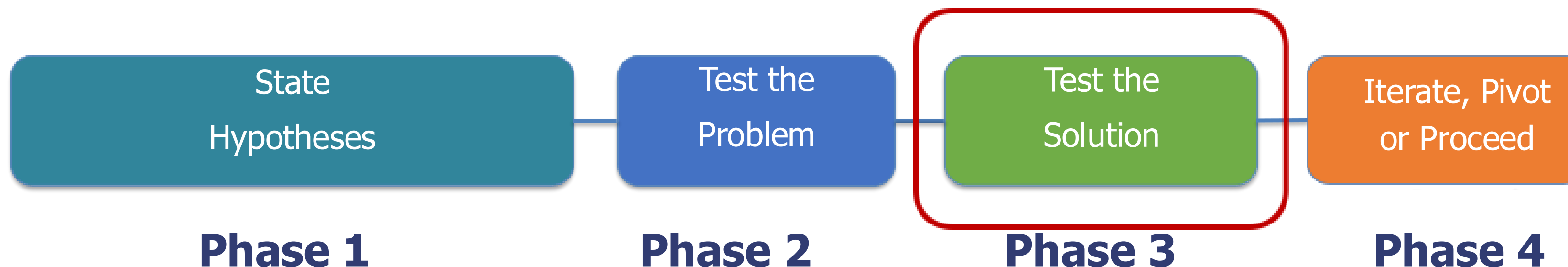
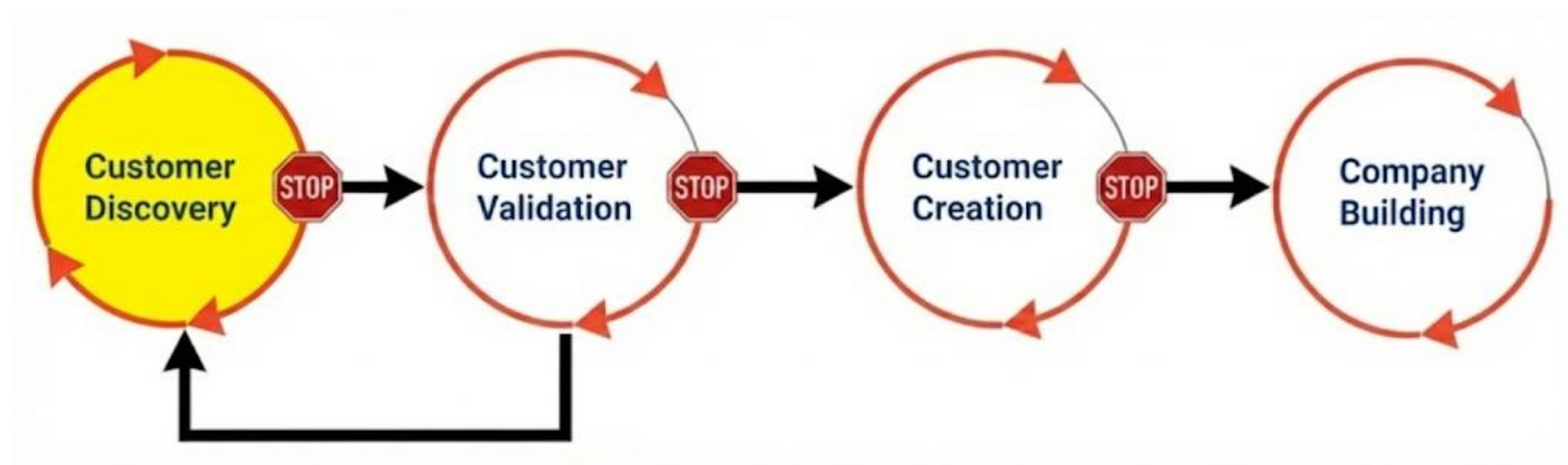
Customer Discovery Overview

Phase 2 : Test the Problem



Revise your BMC based on Testing your Problem

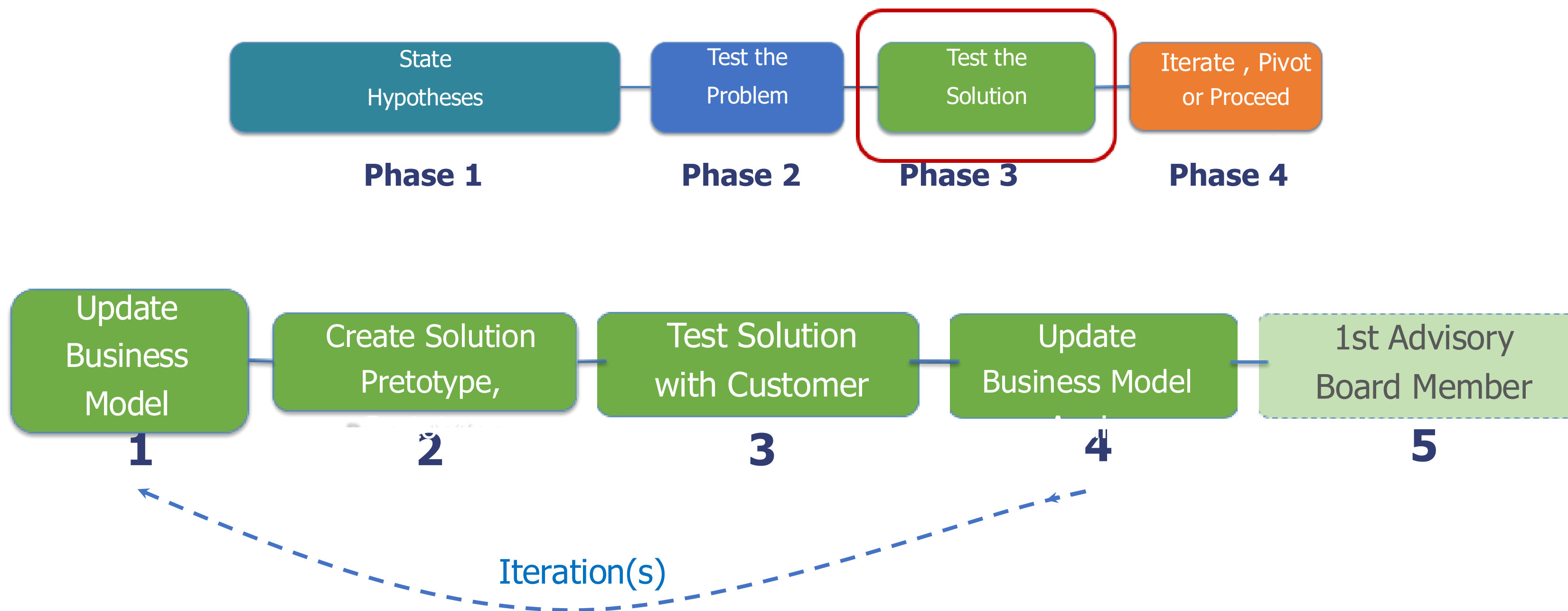
Customer Discovery Overview



Testing the **Solution** comes *after* narrowing down on the **Problem**

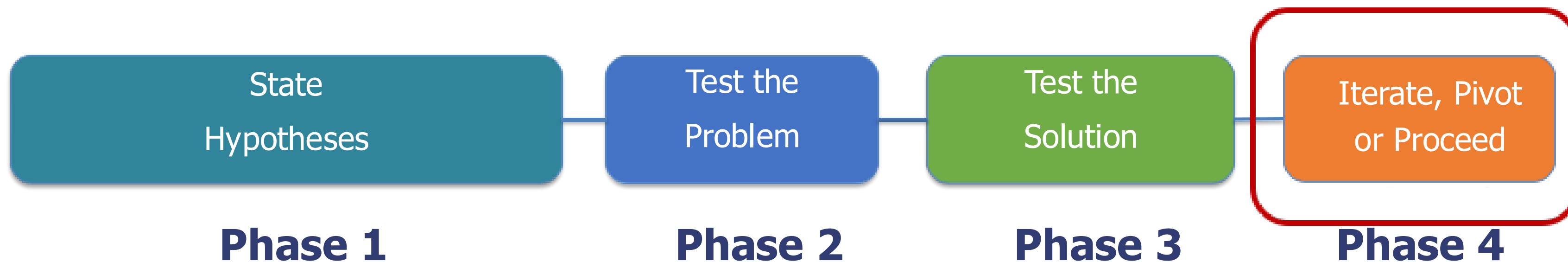
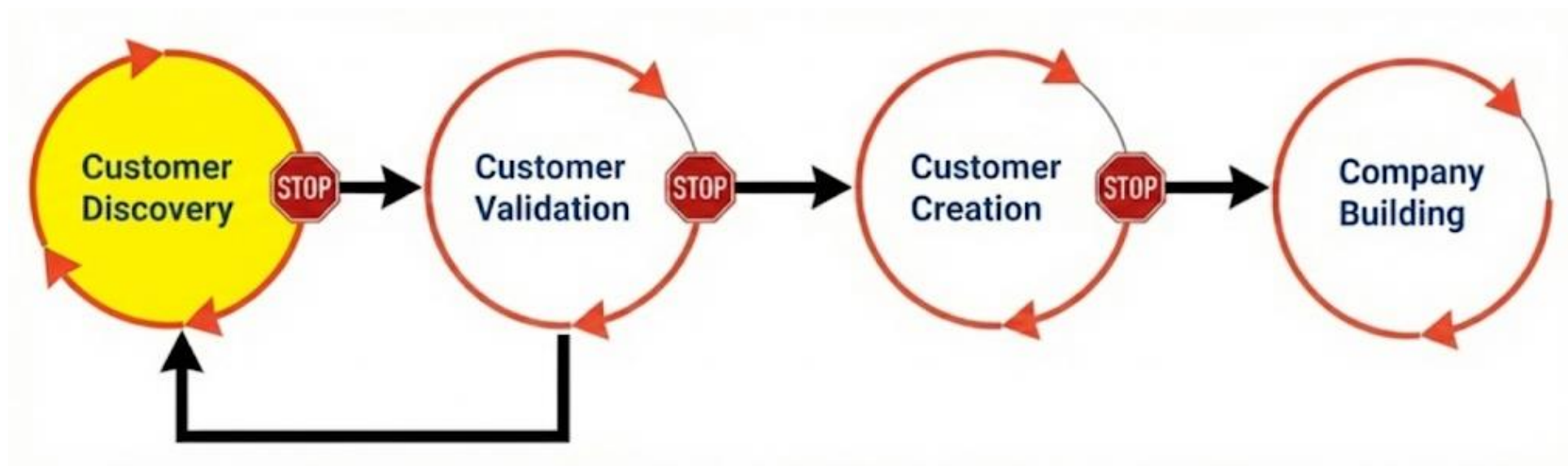
Customer Discovery Overview

Phase 3 : Test the Solution



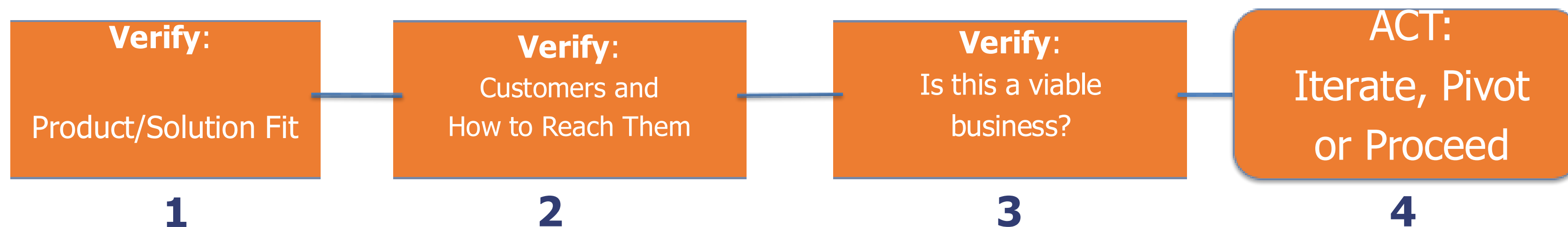
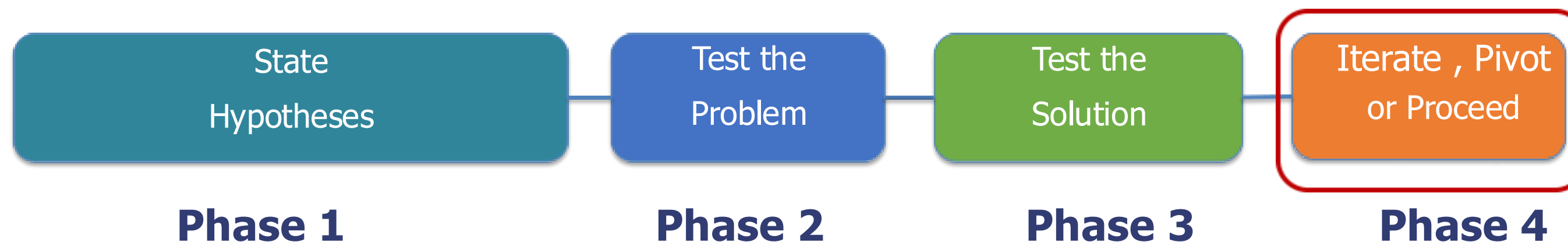
Iterate and Revise your BMC based on Testing your Solution

Customer Discovery Overview



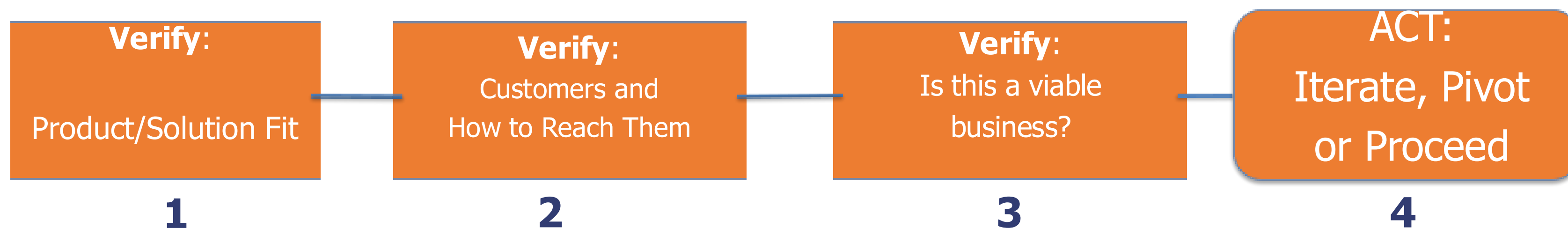
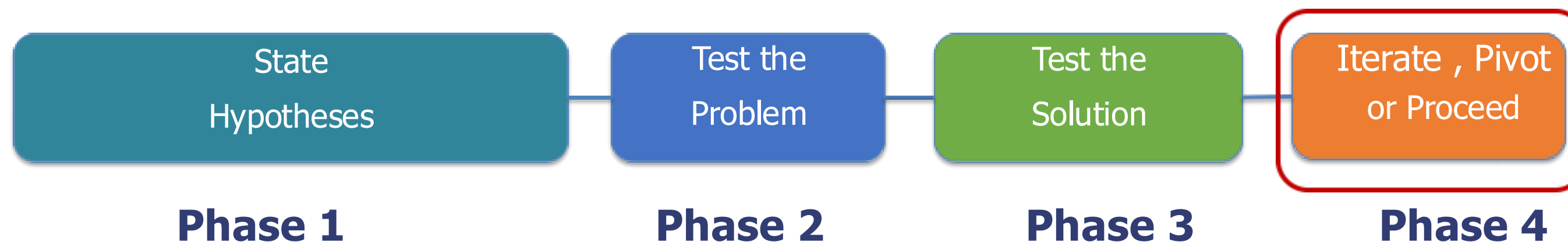
Customer Discovery Overview

Phase 4 : Iterate, Pivot or Proceed



Customer Discovery Overview

Phase 4 : Iterate, Pivot or Proceed



Build-Pivot-Kill-Buy

Classroom Decision Scenario

Product Name (fictional): *NoteSync AI*

An AI tool that automatically records, transcribes, summarizes, and organizes college lectures into searchable notes for students.

Target Users:

- Undergraduate students (18–22 years)
- Online / hybrid learners

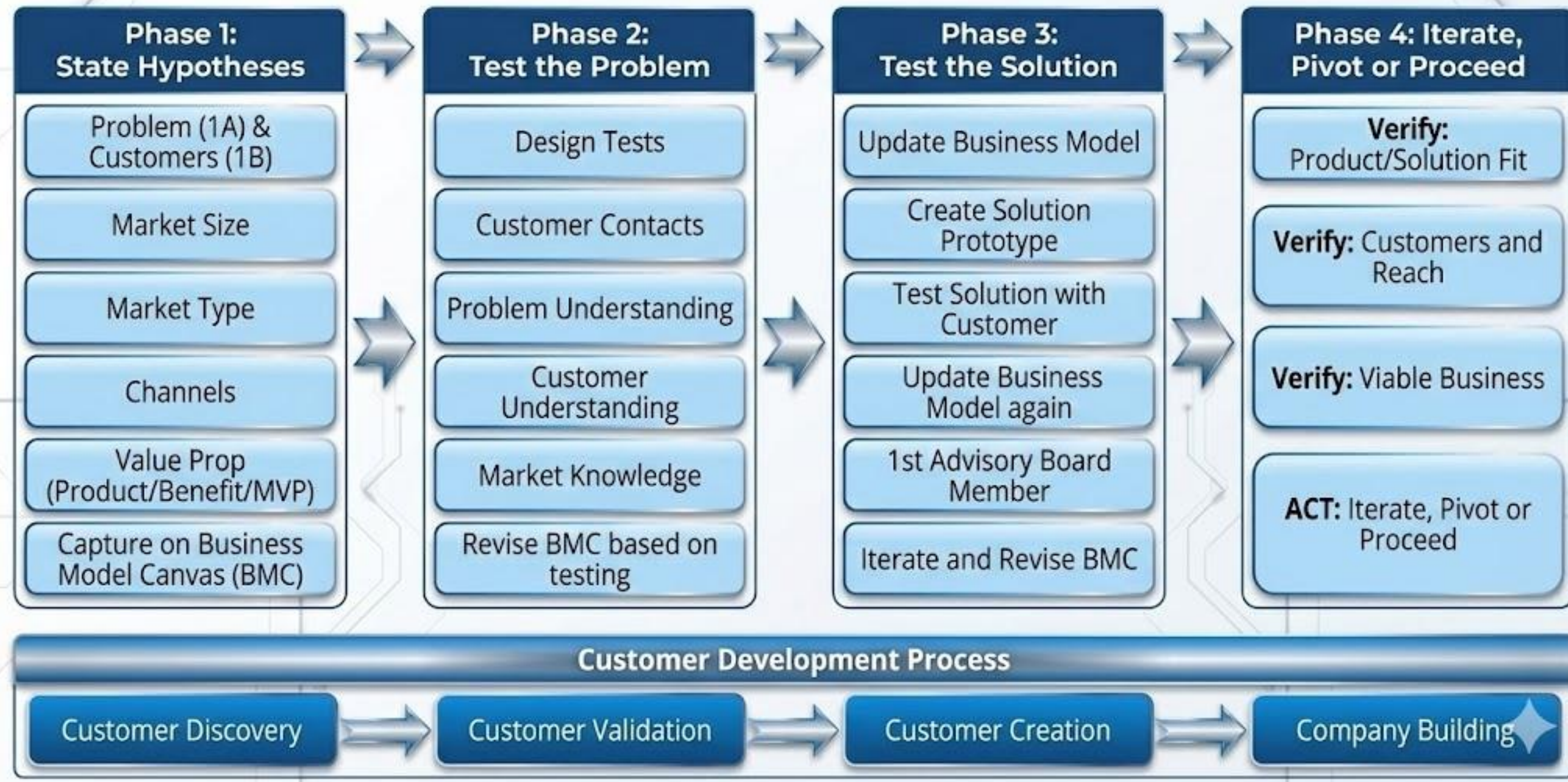
Core Features:

- Auto lecture recording
- AI-generated summaries
- Keyword-based search
- Integration with Google Classroom / Teams

Business Model:

- ₹299/month student subscription
- ₹99/month student subscription
- Sell B2B Licences to Universities/Colleges
- Freemium with limited summaries

Customer Discovery Overview



'9 Deadly Startup Sins' by Steve Blank

[Link](#)

Assuming “I know what the customer wants”

The “I know what features to build” flaw

Focus on launch date

Emphasis on execution instead of hypotheses, testing, learning and iteration

Tradition business plans presume no trial and no errors

Confusing traditional job titles with what a startup needs to accomplish

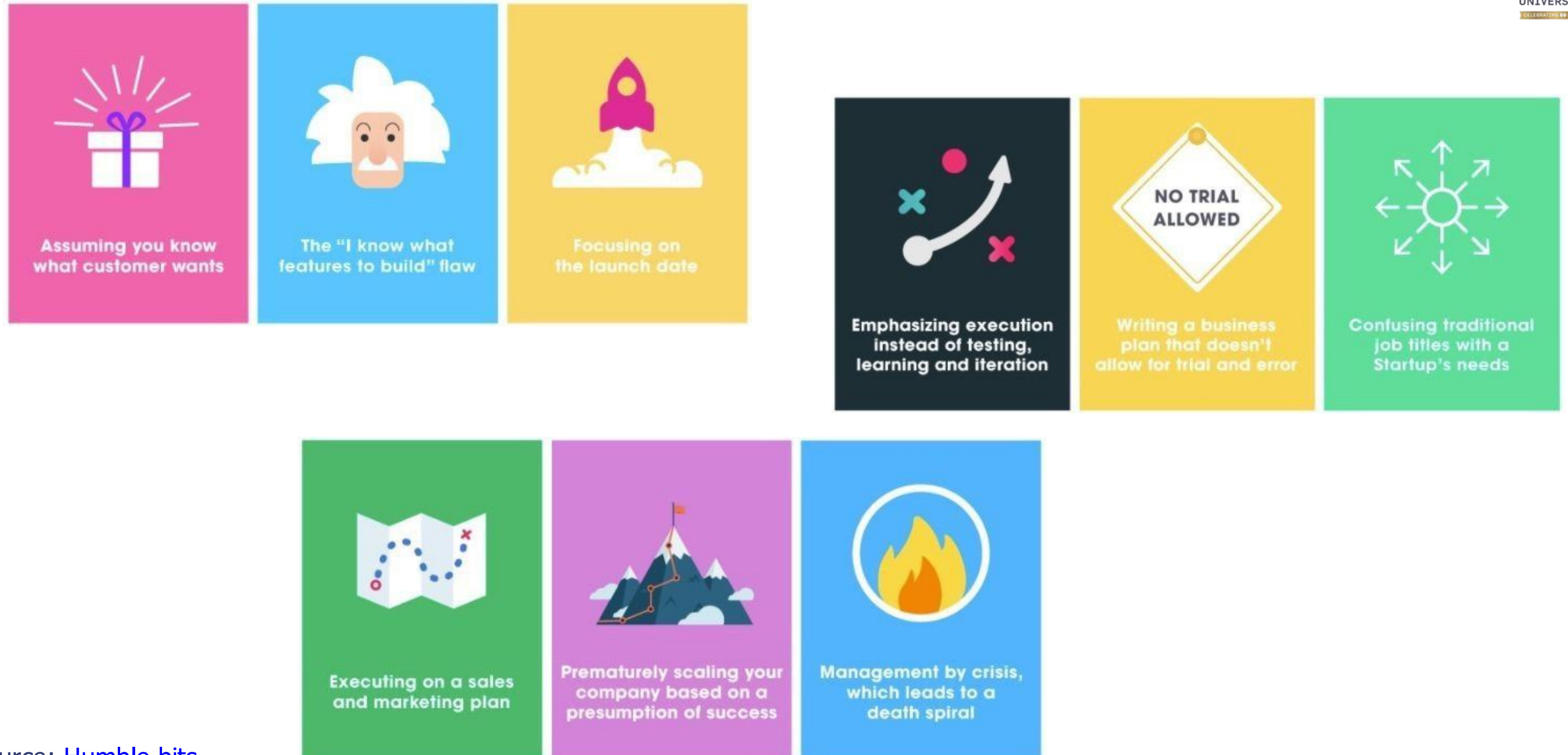
Sales and Marketing execute to a plan

Presumption of success leads to premature scaling

Management by Crisis leads to “Death Spiral”

System Preferences

'9 Deadly Startup Sins'



Examples



Dropbox

Customer Discovery: Drew Houston, the founder of Dropbox, initially created a video demo of the product and posted it on a technology forum to gauge interest and gather feedback. The overwhelmingly positive response from potential customers helped validate the idea and demonstrate the demand for an easy-to-use file storage and sharing solution.

Impact: Armed with valuable customer feedback, Dropbox was launched in 2007, offering cloud-based file storage and synchronisation. The company's customer-centric approach, which focused on addressing user needs and pain points, contributed to its rapid growth and widespread adoption. Today, Dropbox is a leading cloud storage provider with millions of users worldwide.

Examples



Zappos

Customer Discovery: Zappos, an online shoe and clothing retailer, has built its success on a foundation of exceptional customer service. In the early stages, founder Tony Hsieh recognized the importance of understanding customer needs and expectations. He personally spoke with customers to gain insights into their preferences and pain points.

Impact: Zappos prioritised customer satisfaction and went beyond selling products by focusing on creating a delightful shopping experience. This customer-centric approach paid off, and Zappos became known for its outstanding customer service and loyalty. In 2009, Amazon acquired Zappos for over \$1 billion, recognising the company's commitment to customer satisfaction.

Summary

- **Outside Perspective:** Facts lie beyond your walls.
- **Problem-Solution Testing:** Hypotheses validation.
- **Product-Market Alignment:** Early adopter validation.
- **Sales as Proof:** Create after validating sales.
- **Transition Wisely:** Evolve from startup to company.
- **Adaptive Growth:** Embrace chaos for innovation.



Expert Talk: Medha Koppam



Expert Talk: Medha Koppam



Current Role

Medha is a Research Fellow at Microsoft Research, focused on AI for Software Engineering and building reliable tools for large-scale code changes. She works on shipping features used across teams and co-designs AI systems for code transformation and testing.

Previous Experience

She previously interned at Couchbase and Rakuten, working on AI-powered optimization and debugging.

Leadership & Recognition

She served as the British Deputy High Commissioner for a day.

Achievements & Competitions

Under CIE's mentorship, her team won the Cisco ThingQbator contest for a mental-health app idea.



Expert Talk: Rahul Srinivas



Expert Talk: Rahul Srinivas



Current Role

Rahul Srinivas is Chief of Staff at AstraFin Neosolutions, working from the Founder's Office across product, go-to-market, and strategy. He drives product execution, GTM, and cross-functional delivery.

Previous Experience

He was previously Founder's Staff at Klub in Singapore, leading fundraising, investor relations, strategy, and new products. Earlier, he worked in the SaaS Pay Founder's Office from Associate Product Manager to Senior Manager across product, partnerships, and revenue.

Entrepreneurship & Industry Experience

He co-founded Sublit with over ten thousand daily users, with technology adopted by PES University, taught at Refining Skills, and interned at Bosch and Liebherr on data-driven manufacturing and analytics.



Expert Talk: Kartikeya Jain



Expert Talk: Kartikeya Jain

Education: B.Tech in Computer Science & Engineering, PES University (2021)



Current Role: Technical Project Manager at Amadeus, driving end-to-end planning, execution, and risk mitigation for customer-facing services and incident management.

Innovation & GenAI exposure: Holder of two international intellectual property disclosures (Defensive Publications) in the field of Generative AI, focused on building internal efficiency tools.

Career Path: Progressed from Developer → Customer Delivery Manager → Scrum Master → Program Manager, gaining comprehensive exposure to both technical execution and business portfolios.



Team Activity 1 - Know Your Team

Members

1. Partition a KG cardboard* area into (# of members + 1) sections
 2. For each member, capture the response to below questions in respective sections:
 - a. What best describes you? (1 word/sentence)
 - b. One thing your team should know about you to get along well.
 - c. Who's your role model?
 - d. Happiest moment of your life.
 - e. Most difficult moment/incident of your life.
 - f. One game-changing (even if 'impossible') idea
 1. Fill the remaining section, capture 10 things that you all/team members have in common
- * This can be adapted for virtual environment – be creative!

Team Activity 2 – Your Team Identity / Introduction

- Team Name/Logo, Members Name & Photo, Tag-line
- Team Member role(s) in the new startup
- 1 Fun Fact about the team 😊
- Team Goal (what you plan to create/accomplish by semester end)
- What makes us a Team:
 - Strength, Weakness
 - Common interests, values, beliefs, etc
 - 2-3 areas/themes team is excited to explore (e.g health, edu, etc)



1 Slide (see backup for template)
(becomes team's cover slide for *all* future presentations; get creative in designing this!)

1-2 slides (or video) –
Get creative!

Report out
[5 mins/team]